

milkymist[®]

BUTTER

ALWAYS ON THE TABLE

YOUR EASY PROTEIN FIX



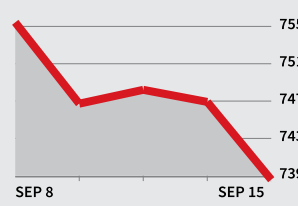
ZERO
ADDED SUGAR

ZERO
PRESERVATIVES

BACTO
CLARIFIED
MILK

the hindu businessline

SENSEX 74003.82 (-777.94)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	23118.60	-279.50
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	19.60	-0.21
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.95	+0.40
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	150298.00	-1032
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	228741.00	-179

SANSKRIT AI MODEL.

FM Nirmala Sitharaman says Sanskrit’s precision and structured grammar give it a natural advantage in the AI era **p7**



AUTO BOOM.

A favourable ecosystem helped automakers post record sales in August, says SIAM **p2**

BENGALURU - CHENNAI - COIMBATORE - HUBBALLI - HYDERABAD - KOCHI - KOLKATA - MADURAI - MALAPPURAM - MANGALURU - MUMBAI - NOIDA - THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - TIRUCHIRAPALLI - VIJAYAWADA - VISAKHAPATNAM

Regd. TN/AR/D/14/2012-2014, RNI No. 55320/94

G-Sec yields hit four-month high on RBI OMO sales push

MARKETS IN A ROUT. Crude shock sends the rupee, Sensex and Nifty tumbling

Our Bureau
Mumbai

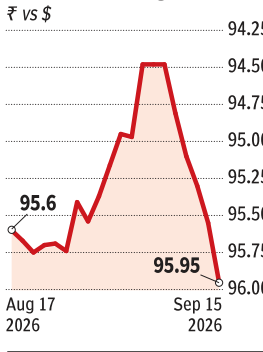
Government bond yields surged on Tuesday, with the benchmark 10-year G-sec briefly testing the crucial 7.1 per cent mark amid concerns over RBI liquidity tightening, heavy debt supply and adverse global cues.

The benchmark 10-year yield opened at 7.09 per cent and rose to an intra-day high of 7.097 per cent, its highest level since May 21, 2026, before settling at 7.073 per cent, the highest closing level since May 22. Bond yields have been climbing since last week as investors reassess the interest rate outlook amid persistent inflationary pressures and tighter liquidity conditions.

OMO SALES

The latest spike follows the Reserve Bank of India’s announcement of ₹1 lakh crore open market operation (OMO) sales, adding to supply pressures in a market already grappling with sizeable issuances of government securities and State development loans (SDLs).

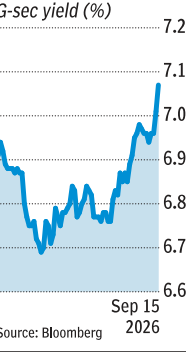
Weakening rupee



Sensex **↓ 777.94 pts**

Nifty **↓ 279.50 pts**

Yields on the rise



Brent crude **\$107.05 per barrel**

“The rise in G-Sec yields today reflects RBI’s announcement of OMO sales. More pressure already persisted due to supply of G-Sec and SDL expected to exceed market demand. The RBI’s OMO sales will add to supply pressure. Moreover, the global environment is unfavourable with the rise in US Treasury yields and a surge in crude price,” said Gaura Sengupta, Chief Economist, IDFC First Bank.

Adding to market nervousness, the rupee weakened past the 96-per-dollar mark

during intra-day trade before recovering to close at 95.95 against the US dollar, down 40 paise from its previous close of 95.55.

The weakness in the currency, coupled with Brent crude prices hovering at \$105-107 a barrel, has heightened concerns over imported inflation.

“Global bond yields remain elevated, while higher domestic inflation and surplus liquidity have prompted the RBI to step up liquidity absorption through VRRR auctions and OMO sales,” said

Venkatkrishnan Srinivasan, Founder and Managing Partner, Rockfort Fincap LLP.

Market participants said concerns are now shifting beyond supply pressures to the possibility of a prolonged higher-for-longer interest-rate cycle. Some research houses have also flagged the risk of a 25-basis-point repo rate hike at the RBI’s October policy review.

INDICES DOWN

The weakness in the bond market coincided with a broader risk-off sentiment across financial assets. The Sensex fell 777.94 points to 74,003.82, while the Nifty declined 279.50 points to 23,118.60.

“Markets witnessed sharp profit-taking after a strong start, with selling pressure at higher levels dragging benchmark indices lower. The near-term bias remains cautious amid heightened volatility,” said Shrikant Chouhan, Head of Equity Research, Kotak Securities.

Looking ahead, traders are closely watching the 7.1-7.15 per cent zone as the next resistance level for the benchmark bond yield.

UPI merchant payments above ₹2,000 to attract 0.4% MDR

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

Come October 15, transactions of more than ₹2,000 between a person and a merchant will attract Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) at 0.4 per cent. This means a person will pay ₹12 for a ₹3,000 transaction.

At the same time, the stock market and mutual funds will get relief, with MDR at 0.02 per cent, capped at ₹300. Also, for transactions above ₹75,000, the maximum MDR has been capped at ₹300.

For specific merchant categories such as railways, telecom services, insurance and fuel, a flat MDR of ₹5 per transaction will apply to transactions above ₹2,000.

“There is no impact on small-value UPI transactions up to ₹2,000, which comprise more than 95 per cent of the total volume of UPI (P2M) transactions,” NPCI said.

Further, person-to-person transactions will continue to be free of cost for both payer and beneficiary. There will be no charge for any person transferring or receiving any amount to or from any other person (or even self-transfers) using UPI.

Details p3

Aug exports jump 26%; dip in imports trims trade deficit

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

Goods exports shot up 26.13 per cent year-on-year in August — the highest so far this fiscal — to \$43.81 billion, led by petroleum product shipments, according to government data.

Imports increased, too, during the month, albeit at a lower rate of 14.1 per cent to \$70.67 billion as gold imports declined by almost half to \$2.3 billion, shrinking the trade deficit in August to \$26.86 billion from \$27.2 billion in August 2025.

GROWTH DRIVERS

The “exceptional” growth in exports was driven by a dynamic mix of commodities and key partner countries, Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal said at a media briefing on Tuesday.

During April-August 2026-27, merchandise exports rose 17.85 per cent year-on-year to \$215.91 billion, while imports grew at a slightly faster 18.21 per cent to \$363 billion. As a result, the merchandise trade deficit widened to \$147.09 billion in the first five months of the fiscal from \$123.88 billion in April-August 2025-26.

“We have seen good performances across engineering goods, petroleum products, chemicals and tex-

KEY INDICATORS

- Goods exports surge 26.13% to \$43.81 billion in Aug
- Imports stood at \$70.67 billion
- Trade deficit fell to \$26.86 billion

RBI files caveat in Bombay HC over Tata Sons listing issue

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

The Reserve Bank of India is said to have filed a caveat in the Bombay High Court, anticipating a legal challenge by Tata Sons of the central bank rejecting its request for de-classification as an unregistered core investment company.

The pre-emptive move is designed to ensure that the RBI gets an opportunity to present its arguments before any court grants interim relief to Tata Sons or any other party challenging the regulator’s decision.

The RBI on Friday communicated that Tata Sons will have to comply with criteria applicable to Non-Banking Financial Corporation-Upper Layer immediately while rejecting Tata Sons’ plea. This effectively means that Tata Sons will have to list its shares.

The RBI’s letter will be placed before the Tata Sons board meeting on Friday, for a decision on the next steps.

Last year, Tata Trusts, which owns 66 per cent stake in Tata Sons, had passed a resolution asking the holding company to engage with the RBI to keep itself private.

Also read p2

It’s not just about building successful businesses.
It’s about transforming lives for eight decades.

Deeply connected to the land.

Adventz is now

PODDAR

SAROJ PODDAR GROUP



www.sarojpoddargroup.com



Fertilisers

Freight Wagons

Real Estate

Furniture Fittings

Engineering

Financial Services

Russia calculus

Delhi's diplomacy with Moscow affirms strategic autonomy

The just-concluded BRICS summit was not just about the Russia-China-led pushback against unilateral tariffs and sanctions by the US and the demand for expansion of multilateral institutions. A key highlight was the India-Russia engagement as a parallel development.

In the run-up to the summit, Russia's flagship industrial trade fair, INNOPROM India, was held in Delhi where trade ministers from both countries held extensive dialogue. This was followed by President Vladimir Putin's unusually strong emphasis on trade, investment, payments, technology and connectivity in a bilateral meeting with Prime Minister Narendra Modi. This marks a shift from a decade ago, when the political and military relationship between the two countries outweighed the economic one. Trade has since risen to nearly \$70 billion, with both sides targeting \$100 billion by 2030. Russia's 2022 invasion of Ukraine triggered Western sanctions that forced Moscow to redirect its energy exports. Indian refiners seized the opportunity to buy discounted crude. The upheaval in the Middle East has reinforced Russia's role as an oil supplier.

India need not be apologetic about buying Russian oil so long as the trade stays economically viable. Simultaneously, it should push for greater Russian purchases of pharmaceuticals and engineering goods as the trade deficit has ballooned (a \$50 billion trade deficit against India). India should also pitch for Russian investment. It is significant that the \$100 billion trade target comes with a \$50 billion two-way investment ambition. The proposed Su-57 fighter offer, with local production and technology transfer, signals deeper industrial ties rather than simple defence purchases. This links up with Russia's emphasis on BRICS payment systems. Putin's pitch for BRICS to become more practical on payments, investment, and technology is aimed at creating economic room outside US systems. India need not share Moscow's idea of BRICS as a counterweight to the West to recognise the utility of such a platform.

Its strategic autonomy remains relevant. Washington may like to see international relations through a binary lens, but India does not have to be either with the US or against it. India can work on deepening ties with the US, while continuing to buy Russian oil, maintaining defence cooperation with Moscow or working with Russia within BRICS and the SCO. After all, the US maintains vast commercial ties with China even as it names Beijing a strategic rival. However, this assertion of geopolitical pragmatism has not gone down well in the US. Barely 48 hours after the BRICS summit, the Lindsey Graham Bill was again in focus in Washington, with the proposed legislation carrying the possibility of tariffs of up to 100 per cent on countries buying Russian energy. Washington's discomfort cannot override India's interests. Yet, 'multi-aligned' India is unlikely to run with an anti-Western bloc — even as it cannot easily accept its choices being constrained by Washington.

POCKET



VISHNU SUMANTH

We live amidst a gamification of the world. From electoral outcomes to sporting victories and celebrity breakups, every “Yes” and “No” is now an ‘event outcome’ capable of monetisation on online ‘prediction markets’ like Kalshi and Polymarket. Public discourse has, thus far, quite rightly viewed such platforms as glorified online casinos. However, recent commentary by market insiders argues that such markets serve a greater economic role as ‘information aggregators’ and ‘universal insurance’. Such arguments push for laissez faire regulation of prediction markets, and advocate their expansion and further institutionalisation. As these opinions gain traction, a comprehensive and categorical rebuttal is necessary in the interests of informed public discourse.

Proponents of prediction markets argue as follows. Prediction markets, like regular forecasting/punditry, allow people to express their informed opinions on current events. People don't just make predictions, but are compelled to ‘put their money where their mouth is’, ensuring more informed and careful predictions. By financialising public opinion, these markets aggregate information more efficiently than regular forecasting models ever could. This creates a ‘truth machine’ that gives us a window into the future, they say.

Further, proponents also argue that these binary Yes/No bets (called ‘event contracts’) offer a revolutionary new way to hedge against real-world risk. If you can bet against an election result that might impact your life negatively, you are ‘insuring’ yourself against the consequences, they say.

INSURABLE INTEREST

This comparison with insurance is where the case for laissez faire prediction markets begins to fall apart. Legally speaking, the difference between an insurance contract and a speculative wager is the existence of insurable interest in the underlying event. Simply put, a contract that pays me if my house burns down is an insurance contract because I have a vested interest in ensuring my house doesn't burn down. Absent this vested interest, a contract that, let's say, pays me if a stranger's house burns down, is a purely speculative wager, better known as... a gamble. The doctrine of insurable interest has an expansive and sophisticated ambit, encompassing a wide range of personal and commercial risks. Therefore, where genuine risks exist, regulated insurance markets are usually fully equipped to help mitigate them. Prediction markets do away with



GETTY IMAGES

Prediction markets must be reined in

NO BETS. They shouldn't get a strong legal foothold as that will bring about an unprecedented drain on productive capital

this crucial doctrine entirely, allowing people to monetise outcomes they aren't directly impacted by. Legally speaking, this is gambling, plain and simple. It is a fundamental economic principle (Posner, *et al.*) that mandating insurable interest in contingent contracts ensures that such contracts only hedge against existing risk, and don't create new risk. The reason is fairly intuitive.

POSITIVE-SUM ECONOMICS

Most tradeable investment contracts (shares, bonds, etc.) are what economists call positive-sum transactions. For instance, when an investor buys a company's bonds, the money so raised is used by the company to do business, make a profit, and return some part thereof to the investor as interest. This is a ‘win-win’ situation that creates wealth and facilitates economic growth. Event contracts on the other hand, are zero-sum games, i.e., what one party wins, the other necessarily loses. There is no economic activity underlying these bets, which create no wealth and facilitate no growth. In light of this vital difference, the strongest case against legalising/institutionalising prediction markets is not a moral diatribe against gambling, but basic economics.

WHAT ABOUT DERIVATIVES?

In a bid to overcome this objection, proponents point to derivative markets (futures, options, swaps, etc.). They argue that speculators are routinely allowed to trade zero-sum oil futures or forex swaps without trading the underlying oil or foreign exchange, so why this double standard? This is a tempting, yet fallacious argument. Derivative markets for securities/commodities exist precisely

because transactions in the underlying securities/commodities are positive-sum. Speculation on derivative markets is grudgingly tolerated as a necessary evil so that genuine businesspeople can find counterparties to their hedges easily and at a variety of price points. Prediction markets on the other hand, support no positive-sum economic activity whatsoever, and the question of tolerating speculation as a necessary evil simply does not arise.

TRUTH MACHINES?

This is a small price to pay for the ‘truth machine’, proponents persist. Telling the future surely cannot be of zero economic value! But far from telling the future, prediction markets create deeply perverse incentives that reward active sabotage in the real world. When the payout for an event occurring exceeds the cost of making that event occur, each bet mobilizes an army of bounty hunters looking to ‘fix’ outcomes. The dangers of such manipulation in the real world are grave, extend well beyond the economy, and are already starting to be seen.

The tradability of event contracts on exchanges also raises concerns of insider trading, where people with non-public information about events unfairly use such information to profit at the market's expense. A market compromised by widespread manipulation and insider trading cannot

Institutionalisation of prediction markets will turn the real world into a gamified nightmare, with every bet subject to widespread sabotage and bounty hunting

yield a reliable truth signal.

Proponents brush these concerns aside, arguing that prediction markets will be tightly regulated just like existing securities markets. This naively ignores the impossibly large scale of the regulatory state required to make such markets fair and transparent. A regulator would have to monitor every world event, every stakeholder involved in said event, prevent sabotage, and ensure that ‘insiders’ (once somehow identified) are not trading on non-public information. This is practically impossible, and moreover, for a zero-sum activity, a colossal waste of state capacity. Investigating and punishing manipulation and insider trading in securities markets is already a highly complicated and technical endeavour, requiring significant public investment. Modern regulations mandate continuous insider disclosures, information-flow tracking, and algorithmic trade monitoring. Regulation along these lines for prediction markets is inconceivable at scale, and would render privacy rights meaningless.

The widespread growth and institutionalisation of prediction markets will bring about an unprecedented drain on productive capital. It will turn the real world into a gamified nightmare, with every bet subject to widespread sabotage and bounty hunting. In a world where fair and effective regulation is impossible, we must ensure these markets do not gain a strong legal foothold in any growth-oriented economy, regardless of nationality, jurisdiction or regulatory environment. Growth is built, not waged.

The writer is a corporate and tax lawyer based in Chennai

GST on staffing needs to be reduced

Taxing formal employment at a premium will nudge workers back towards informal and gig arrangements

Suchita Dutta

India has quietly built one of the world's three largest formal flexi-staffing industries. A single tax setting is now holding it back from becoming something far larger. The 56th GST Council, meeting on September 3, 2025, delivered the most sweeping tax reform since 2017. GST 2.0 collapsed the old multi-slab regime into two principal rates, 5 per cent and 18 per cent, and moved more than 200 items down, with 99 per cent of goods in the erstwhile 12 per cent slab shifting to 5 per cent from September 22.

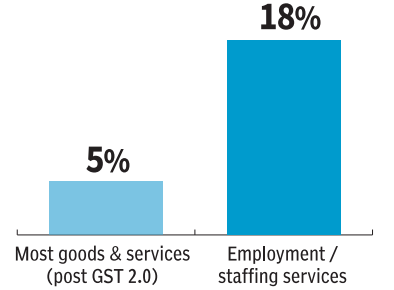
The intent: tax essentials lightly, expand consumption, and widen the formal economy. Employment services were left untouched at 18 per cent.

CHARGED ON ENTIRE INVOICE

That is the anomaly. For every ₹100 a company now spends on goods taxed at 5 per cent, it pays just ₹5 in tax. Spend the same ₹100 on formal staffing and the levy is ₹18, a 3.6-times gap on labour, the one input no business can do without. Because GST on staffing is charged on the entire invoice, most of which is the worker's own wage passed through, the burden lands hardest on the sectors we most want to formalise: MSMEs, consumer-facing industries, and GST-exempt services such as healthcare

The employment-services anomaly under GST 2.0

Staffing is taxed 3.6x higher than most goods after GST 2.0



Source: 56th GST Council / GST 2.0 (eff. Sep 22, 2025); Indian Staffing Federation

and education that cannot claim input tax credit. The consequences are measurable. Indian Staffing Federation estimates the 18 per cent rate drains ₹20,000-30,000 crore from business liquidity every year and is on course to reduce formal temporary hiring by 10-15 per cent in affected sectors this fiscal, nudging workers back towards informal and gig arrangements that carry no provident fund, no insurance, and no wage protection. Taxing formal employment at a premium, while goods enjoy relief, is a policy working against itself.

Consider what this industry already delivers. Our member companies alone employed 1.83 million formal flexi workers by June 2025, and the organised flexi sector now supports roughly 7.2 million people, about 1.3 per cent of India's workforce, among the world's top three flexi-staffing markets. In the last financial year, the sector paid an estimated ₹1.47 lakh crore in wages and ₹52,800 crore towards social security and GST.

CONTRACT EMPLOYMENT

Logistics, BFSI and manufacturing together account for around 38 per cent of formal contract employment, with twelve core sectors making up 80 per cent of demand.

Nearly a quarter of these workers are women, and most are young, first-time entrants receiving their very first formal job, complete with EPF, ESI and a bank-credited salary. This is formalisation delivered by the market: jobs, not doles.

The headroom is the real story. India's flexi penetration, at 1.3 per cent, still trails the US (1.8 per cent) and Europe (1.6 per cent), and it sits against an informal economy that accounts where some 400 million people outside the formal social-security net. Converting even a modest slice of that into organised, contributory employment is, on any reasonable arithmetic, a

20-million-job opportunity. ISF projects the market to compound at over 17 per cent a year towards ₹2.58 lakh crore by FY27, and independent analysis expects the sector to create several million additional livelihoods by 2030. The demand is plainly there; the binding constraint is fiscal, not structural.

Correcting it is not a concession; it is sound revenue policy. Moving employment services to the 5 per cent merit slab would, by our estimate, release up to ₹50,000 crore in cash flows for reinvestment and fresh hiring.

A lower rate applied to a rapidly formalising base does not shrink the tax net; it widens it, through more compliant payroll, more EPF and ESI contributions, and more GST-registered employment.

This is precisely the logic the government itself applied to goods under GST 2.0. Employment deserves the same treatment.

Employment is the most essential input in any economy. Tax it accordingly. Move employment services to 5 per cent, and India can convert a two-million success story into a 20-million one: formalising work, extending social security to millions, and doing it the durable way, through jobs.

The writer is Executive Director, Indian Staffing Federation (ISF)

LETTERS TO EDITOR

Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to 'Letters to the Editor', The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

BRICS' balancing act

This refers to the editorial 'BRICS and gaps' (September 14). Geopolitical tensions have forced India to exercise considerable caution in balancing its relationship with Russia and Ukraine on one hand and Israel and Iran on the other. The US has, in many ways, been an instrumental force in shaping this increasingly complex multipolar disorder. China, rich in critical minerals and a major supplier of active pharmaceutical ingredients, maintains substantial trade surpluses with several BRICS countries. However, it should not

seek merely to further augment the surpluses and emerge as the bloc's big brother. Fair, equitable and non-discriminatory trade practices will be crucial in ensuring that BRICS develops into a stronger, more cohesive bloc in a world mostly dominated by Western alliances.

S Lakshminarayanan

Ko Puvannur & Post, TN

Effective AI regulation

Warnings from leaders of the world's leading AI companies that the technology could become powerful enough to pose a serious risk to

humanity within six months to a year may sound like dystopian fiction, but they cannot be dismissed lightly. The danger of allowing companies racing to develop a deeply transformative technology to set their own limits is too serious to ignore. What is needed is effective regulation that establishes clear safety standards without stifling innovation. More importantly, the international community must create a global framework to prevent the dangerous use of super-intelligent AI in cyberwarfare, bioterrorism and large-scale economic disruption. AI

is already being integrated into critical sectors such as banking, transport, healthcare and defence. The world cannot afford to wait for a catastrophe before acting. Responsible innovation must, therefore, go hand in hand with global oversight, transparency and enforceable safety norms.

M Jeyaram

Sholavandan, TN

Give peace a chance

This refers to 'Half of Russia's top diesel refineries cut or halt output after drone attacks' (September 15).

It sounds unbelievable that the extensive damage being caused by the Ukraine drones has sharply reduced Russian diesel production, adding pressure to fuel supplies and exports, mainly to Brazil and Turkey. It is no wonder that Russia, which had reportedly claimed to eliminate Ukraine within a week's time (nearly four years ago), is seeing no end in sight to the ongoing war. However, in all fairness, both nations should shed their tactics and give peace a chance to make suitable amends.

SK Gupta

New Delhi

Trump’s dividend card

A \$5,000 cheque promise, a last ditch attempt

Sridhar Krishnaswami

It is not as if US President Donald Trump took a leaf out of George McGovern’s idea in 1972 that if he won the election that year against Richard Nixon he would give Americans \$1000 every year.

But now with about seven weeks to go for the mid-terms, Trump is promising every American adult citizen a dividend cheque of \$5,000 if Republicans keep control of the House of Representatives and Senate on November 3.

Some see in this latest offer as a last ditch effort to keep control of Congress. Getting away from the conventional wisdom that the President’s party falls short in the mid-terms, the general thinking — even within the Grand Old Party — is that the numbers would fall short in the House and perhaps even in the Senate. And the White House knows well that should Republicans lose one of the two Chambers this Fall, the US President’s legislative agenda is toast.

Even if Republicans manage to hold on to majorities in Congress, getting funds passed for the latest proposal would be a major problem given that the national debt is already at a whopping \$40 trillion.

Americans are not new to dividend cheques, and the latest offer is the third in the series. First was a \$5,000 promise in 2025 from all the savings that was going to come from the initiatives of the Department of Governmental Efficiency (DOGE) spearheaded by Elon Musk and Co.

That expected \$2 trillions in savings never materialised and few took the numbers put out seriously. And there was this \$2,000 dividend cheque floated around, also in the same year, from all the money that was coming America’s way by tariffs.

The US Supreme Court played spoil sport, and now the mad scramble to issue refund cheques to states and companies.

BIG PAYOUT

It is said that there are about 245 million citizens who would make up \$1.2 trillion in payout for Trump’s idea; and it is not clear if the dividend would cover an estimated five million Americans living overseas.

US Vice-President JD Vance has further qualified telling a media outlet that the money is for the “American middle class” and for “American workers”; and that



DONALD TRUMP, Mid-term pressures REUTERS

the amount would be drawn from tariffs collected. All that the White House would say: “President Trump has consistently proven his doubters wrong, drawing a clear contrast with the Democrats’ record of historic inflation, unfettered illegal immigration, skyrocketing crime, and weakness on the world stage.”

LEGAL FACTOR

And there is the legal problem with some taking exception to Trump’s latest proposal on the grounds that it could violate election laws.

Here again a distinction has been made as candidates are allowed to make campaign promises and that cannot be considered illegal vote buying as every adult citizen would be entitled to the money regardless of their individual vote or registration status.

In other words, Trump will have legal protection including a prior Supreme Court ruling to go through with his latest idea. The question is, will voters oblige?

The worry of the White House and of the Republicans seeking re-election in the House and Senate is well founded.

Trump’s approval rating remains stagnant at 33 per cent, his lowest ever and lower than Joe Biden’s rating at this time in 2024. The Iran war is nowhere near a closure with intensified attacks in and around the Strait of Hormuz further driving up oil prices.

The only ray of hope for the Grand Old Party is that even if Democrats manage to get the House of Representatives, they will be too far apart internally to put up a united show.

A third impeachment of Trump is certainly on the cards but chances of getting a conviction in the Senate is between fat, slim and none.

The writer is a senior journalist who has reported from Washington DC on North America and United Nations

Decoding BRICS’ energy intent

It provides a vital diplomatic cover for India to keep its oil import options open without having to take sides

CAPITAL IDEAS.



RICHA MISHRA

We acknowledge fossil fuels will still play an important role in the world’s energy mix, particularly for emerging markets and developing economies, and we recognize the need to promote just, orderly, equitable and inclusive energy transitions and reduce GHG emissions in line with our climate goals and observing SDG7, and the principles of technological neutrality and common but differentiated responsibilities and respective capabilities taking into account national circumstances, needs and priorities,” reads BRICS New Delhi Declaration of September 12, 2026.

By validating the ongoing importance of fossil fuels, the declaration provides the energy sector with a critical defence: it rejects an aggressive phase-out in favour of a realistic, managed transition, which, some say, is good for India, Russia and Saudi Arabia.

But this should not be seen as a free pass to energy-import reliant nations like India. What BRICS membership actually does is provide vital diplomatic leverage: it keeps India and Iran at the negotiating table, safeguarding India’s access to the strategic Chabahar Port.

KEY POINTS

Energy security: Ensuring energy market stability and maintaining uninterrupted flows of energy from diverse sources, strengthening value chains. This is a priority after West Asia conflict.

Digital and Smart Grids: BRICS pushed AI, data analytics for grid management.

Diversified mix: Declaration lists all sources as important — renewable energy, bioenergy, fossil fuels, nuclear energy, hydropower, hydrogen, low carbon technologies, energy storage.

Critical Minerals Focus on reliable supply chains for lithium, cobalt, copper,



ENERGY SOVEREIGNTY. India must be diplomatically nimble in sourcing oil /ISTOCKPHOTO

but with sovereign rights of resource countries.

Local currencies: Finally, Energy Ministers called for use of local currencies in energy trade.

The declaration provides for Smart Grids & Storage Centre in India; Push for Global Biofuels Alliance; reliable and stable supply chains for minerals. India needs lithium for EVs, solar, semiconductors.

In the wake of ongoing West Asia conflicts and Red Sea disruptions, India wants to insulate its economy by sourcing crude oil from Russia, the Gulf, or the US without the threat of unilateral sanctions. The BRICS Energy Ministers’ parallel push for local currency trade offers a vital financial shield.

Settling transactions in rupees, rubles, or dirhams reduces US dollar dependency, minimises exposure to secondary sanctions, and structurally protects India’s foreign exchange reserves. RBI already has rupee

Settling transactions in rupees, rubles, or dirhams reduces US dollar dependency, minimises exposure to secondary sanctions

settlement mechanism for Russian oil.

With the West Asia conflict disrupting the Strait of Hormuz, the declaration’s emphasis on “diverse sources” provides India with the diplomatic leverage to source oil from Russia, the US, the UAE, and Iraq. Whether this strategic framing explains why New Delhi persistently purchased discounted Russian crude despite heavy Western pressure remains a question only the Ministry of External Affairs can answer.

Protection of critical energy infrastructure, including cross-border infrastructure is a boost for India as this means undersea cables, LNG terminals, proposed India-Middle East-Europe pipeline, and power grid connections with Nepal, Bhutan, Bangladesh could be in offing.

The declaration can even be seen as an endorsement of India’s approach: keep coal and gas for baseload, add solar and wind rapidly, secure oil from cheapest source, and build storage.

THE CHALLENGES

However, there are challenges. BRICS is opposed to EU’s carbon tax, but EU’s CBAM has kicked in from January 1, 2026. Indian steel and aluminium will still pay at EU border from this year. India will need to take this up at WTO and build its own carbon credit system fast. Clearly, just a joint statement won’t

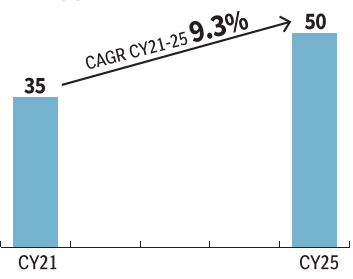
STATISTALK.

Compiled by Nishanth Gopalakrishnan | Graphic KS Gunasekar

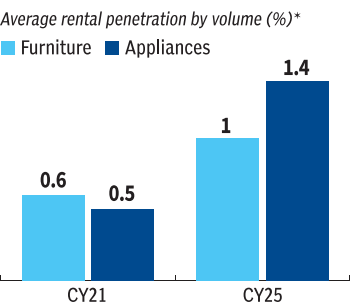
India goes asset light on home furnishing

Rentomojo’s recent IPO prospectus throws light on an ongoing trend in India’s household furniture and appliances market. There is a shift in consumer preference from the traditional ownership model to a more flexible rental model. Consistently high property inflation, wage growth trailing property price growth and a more mobile workforce have made the case for consumers to adopt the rental model. The rental market is nascent, though. Its low base, rising adoption and the headroom for growth are captured in the following charts.

Market size of home furniture and appliances (\$ billion)



Appliance rentals find more takers than for furniture

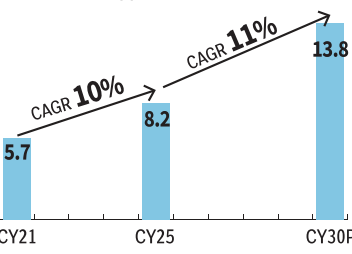


*Average share of rental units delivered in a year compared to units sold in a year

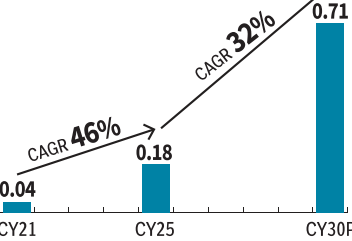
Source: Rentomojo RHP

Rental market’s quicker growth signifies growing adoption of rental model

Furniture and appliance TAM (\$ billion)*



Rental market size (\$ billion)*

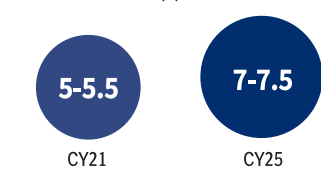


*Assuming 100 per cent adoption of rental models across all relevant households, calculated as the product of (i) the number of addressable households, (ii) average rental spend per household, and (iii) average rental tenure

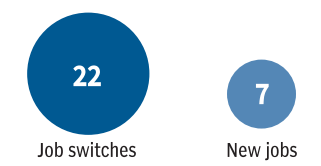
#Current annual revenue generated by active rentals

Key factors driving the rental model

Property price to annual household income (x)



CAGR CY21-25 (%)*



Average tenancy - urban India (years)



*EPFO data

stop the tax. India ramped up Russian oil purchases — from 2 per cent to 35 per cent — because it was cheap (\$20-30 discount), but that is now down to \$3-5 a barrel.

India will get hurt if it gets too reliant on one supplier and US tightens secondary sanctions. Energy security implies diversification of supply sources, not substituting West Asian dependence with Russian dependence.

The Declaration talks about resilient supply chains, but India has no lithium, cobalt, nickel processing. India’s Critical Mineral Mission needs to secure mines in Brazil, South Africa, Argentina, not just MOUs.

A critical question is, will Iran allow free and smooth access? On the face of it Iran is not blocking, but inviting transit right now. The greater risk is not Iran but US sanctions.

Hormuz right now is technically open but practically almost closed. Iran wants to resume oil sales to India to broaden its buyer pool beyond China and India is pushing Chabahar as an alternative to Hormuz, open to Arabian Sea.

Hormuz is not a BRICS waterway, it’s Iranian and Omani sovereign waters. BRICS declaration says ‘undisrupted flows’ and ‘protection of critical infrastructure’ but that doesn’t ensure free access to BRICS.

According to information available, the Iranian side met Indian Oil Ministry top brass on BRICS sidelines specifically to offer crude to India.

As a member of both BRICS and the US-led Quad, India must walk a diplomatic tightrope. Pushing too aggressively for de-dollarisation and Rupee-denominated oil trade risks a backlash from Washington, which could jeopardise critical Western technology transfers in strategic sectors like semiconductors and civil nuclear energy.

Ultimately, New Delhi will need to tread cautiously, ensuring its pursuit of strategic autonomy does not come at the cost of its vital partnerships with the West.

The Declaration gives India political cover, but execution is on India: build storage, fix Discoms, mine minerals, and diversify supply sources.

On businessline.in

When a dollar rain causes rupee flood

How did the NRI community manage to raise such a humongous amount of money in such a short span of time? The answer to this is the most concerning aspect of the FCNR exercise, points out **Prakash Balakrishnan**

<https://tinyurl.com/5efr8dsv>

The search for alternative international reserve currencies

Triffin’s dilemma need not act as an impediment in internationalising a currency, say **Trishna Sarkar** and **C Saratchand**

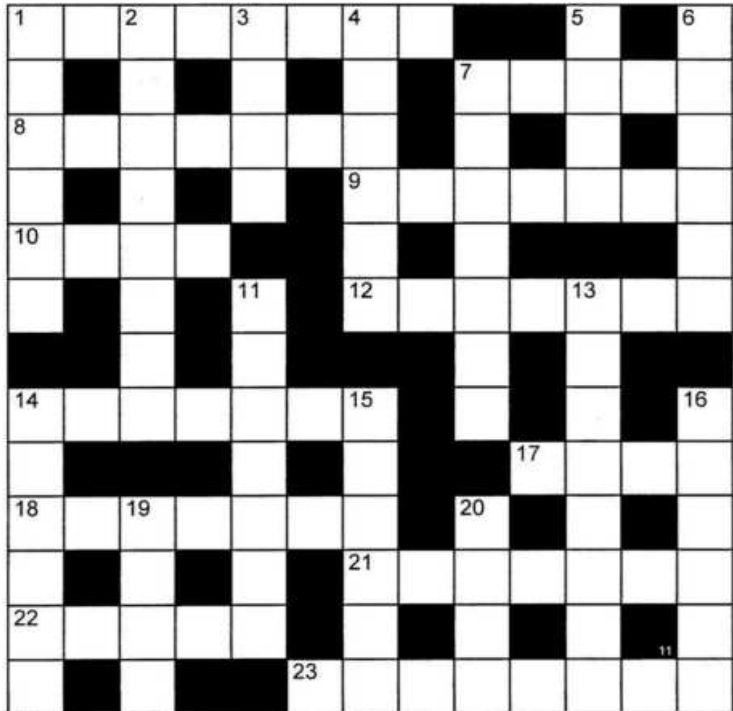
<https://tinyurl.com/2hans4d8>

Ensuring better food safety

More than inspections, notices or products seizures, a more meaningful measure of success is whether compliance across the entire food ecosystem is improving, argues **Vinod Sharma**

<https://tinyurl.com/nyn2adfm>

BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2736



EASY

ACROSS

- Positive (8)
- To be at the wheel (5)
- A private cavalry soldier (7)
- A transgression (7)
- Secret language (4)
- Likely to weep (7)
- Grandeur of mien (7)
- Nought (4)
- To cut short (7)
- Putting ashore (7)
- Hang one by mob law (5)
- Turned on and off (8)

DOWN

- Separate, unfasten (6)
- Inundation (8)
- The back of the neck (4)
- The passage from mouth to stomach (6)
- Bearing, manner (4)
- A grain food (6)
- Let air out of (7)
- Grave inscription (7)
- Having a high temperature (8)
- Easily managed (6)
- The colour of sulphur (6)
- Pertinacious (6)
- Telephoned (4)
- Small irritating biting insect (4)

NOT SO EASY

ACROSS

- It is sure, not like an article (8)
- A spin one may hit forcibly down the pitch (5)
- One who swears it will ship the army overseas (7)
- Belonging to a dealer in stolen property, it’s a crime (7)
- A digest of laws which may be transmitted in secret (4)
- Rule fat out, as one’s liable to cry about it (7)
- High office is what one stands on, expecting respect (7)
- A cipher may be found at the end of countdown (4)
- Make liar cut it out or cut it short (7)
- Is coming down on the level between flights (7)
- Hang local leader, with backing of New York, going to church (5)
- Was beaten as one changed channels (8)

DOWN

- Cadet turning to Heathrow initially for take-off (6)
- Fold in and go like this if there’s too much liquid (8)
- When a person shows the back of his neck (4)
- Hot tar may be used to treat the gullet (6)
- One among fellows having such an air (4)
- Breakfast food sounds as if it should be served in instalments (6)
- Fed up with being behind the clock, let the air out of one’s tyres (7)
- Heap it quietly around the inscription on the gravestone (7)
- It is always, among swimmers, hectic (8)
- Being compliant with the old, ice gets broken (6)
- Cowardly way to cry out : now that’s not new! (6)
- It is persistent, the way one followed somebody (6)
- Race to Gateshead, which is one step up the ladder (4)
- A benign attempt to hold an insect that bites (4)

SOLUTION: BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2735

ACROSS 7. Disappearance 8. Appreciated 12. Formed 14. Happen 16. Allure 18. Claret 19. Examination 23. Starting price

DOWN 1. Diva 2. Ramp 3. Spread 4. Famish 5. Fast 6. Scud 9. Perplex 10. Esparto 11. Knot 12. Flap 13. Ear 15. All 17. Elicit 18. Charge 19. Eats 20. Airy 21. Inro 22. Nick

QUICKLY.

Pranav Constructions turns weak after strong listing



Bengaluru: Shares of Pranav Constructions made a modest debut on the stock exchanges on Tuesday with a listing premium of about 30.6 per cent at ₹162 against the IPO price of ₹124 on the BSE. However, soon after, the stock tumbled 20 per cent to end at the lower circuit of ₹129.60 on the BSE, a gain of 4.5 per cent. On the NSE, the stock opened at ₹165 and closed at ₹132. Shivani Nyati, Head of Wealth, Swastika Investmart, said Pranav Constructions' strong debut was followed by a sharp correction, indicating profit booking and high volatility. She said the company's presence in Mumbai's western suburbs, healthy growth and reasonable IPO valuation remain positives, but advised investors against chasing the stock. **OUR BUREAU**

Fibe owner gets SEBI approval to launch IPO

New Delhi: Social Worth Technologies Ltd, which operates under the brand name Fibe, has secured SEBI's approval to raise funds through an initial public offering (IPO), comprising a fresh issue of shares worth ₹750 crore, an update with the regulator showed on Tuesday. The IPO also includes an offer for sale of over 4 crore shares by existing shareholders, according to the DRHP. Proceeds from the fresh issue will be used to invest in its subsidiary, ESPL, for augmenting its capital base to support onward lending requirements, besides meeting general corporate purposes. Social Worth Technologies received SEBI's final observations on September 15. **PTI**

Co-location scam: Supreme Court refuses Chitra Ramkrishna's plea

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Tuesday refused to entertain former NSE Managing Director Chitra Ramkrishna's plea challenging an order taking cognisance of offences under the anti-corruption law in the co-location scam case against her. Ramkrishna had challenged the Delhi High Court's July 9 verdict which dismissed her plea against a trial court order taking cognizance of the offences under the anti-corruption law in the case against her.. Senior advocate Balbir Singh, appearing for Ramkrishna, argued that the NSE is a private company, and it can't be said that the petitioner was discharging a public duty. While disposing of her plea, the Bench of Justices JB Pardiwala and K

Demand from anchor investors much more than expected, says NSE chief

MEGA OFFER. Anchor book of about ₹6,250 crore opens today; public subscription begins on Thursday

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

Anchor demand for the National Stock Exchange's (NSE) initial public offering (IPO) is much stronger than expected, Managing Director and CEO Ashishkumar Chauhan said on Tuesday. He said the introduction of merchant discount rate (MDR) charges on unified payments interface (UPI) transactions above ₹2,000 will have a short-term impact on transaction volumes. "Anchor book is pretty large, much more than we thought it would be," Chauhan said while addressing a press conference here. The bidding for anchor investors will take place on September 16. "Every group, like local

MFs, has to be allotted specific amount. Anchor book is pretty large, more than we thought," he added. The anchor book is expected to be around ₹6,250 crore, lower than the earlier estimated ₹9,000 crore, with the final investor line-up still being worked out. **MARQUEE INVESTORS** Although he did not give details, people familiar with the matter said investment majors, including Goldman Sachs Asset Management, Franklin Templeton and Fidelity International, were among the early investors showing interest in the anchor book. Also, Norges Bank Investment Management, Abu Dhabi Investment Authority and GIC are likely to participate in the anchor book, they said.



Ashishkumar Chauhan, Managing Director and CEO, addressing a press conference in New Delhi on Tuesday **ANI**

The much-awaited ₹22,569-crore IPO, entirely an offer for sale (OFS), is set to become the country's second-largest public issue after Hyundai Motor India's ₹27,870-crore IPO in 2024. On the possibility of NSE creating a permitted-to-trade category for its shares, Chauhan said the exchange had not applied for it so far and would consult SEBI if it

decides to go for the option.

MPS NORM

On minimum public shareholding (MPS) requirements, Chauhan said NSE would have 100 per cent free float after listing, given its large shareholder base of 2 lakh. The exchange could eventually see stronger demand once its shares become eligible for inclusion in do-

mestic and international indices. Chauhan also said the growth in market volumes would depend partly on broader market conditions. He noted that Indian markets had remained relatively sideways over the last two to three years, while geopolitical developments and changes in the global environment had also affected trading activity. "Sideways markets don't trade that much vis-a-vis bullish markets," he said, adding that a cleaner global environment could lead to higher transaction volumes and changes in the way indices perform. The NSE IPO is scheduled to open for public subscription on September 17 and close on September 21, with the price band of ₹1,700 to ₹1,785 per share.

PNC Infratech dips 20% as NHAI bans firm for 3 years

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Shares of PNC Infratech dipped 20 per cent to ₹140 on Tuesday after the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) levied a three-year debarment on Awadh Expressway, a concessionaire SPV of the company.

It also restricted PNC Infratech from bidding for new MoRTH/NHAI projects for the next three years. However, the company clarified that the action will not impact ongoing projects and said it is exploring legal remedies against the order, adding that any financial implications will be disclosed as clarity emerges.

MDR may alter payment choices, but 'won't curtail market participation'

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The government's decision to levy Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on UPI transactions above ₹2,000 for capital market-related payments is expected to alter payment behaviour among investors, though experts believe the long-term impact on investment activity will be limited.

The MDR framework covers regulated capital market entities, including mutual fund asset management companies (AMCs), SEBI-registered stockbrokers, securities dealers and investment platforms. It applies to UPI payments made for equity and debt investments, mutual fund purchases and broker wallet top-ups. The charge has been fixed at 0.02 per cent of the transaction value, capped at ₹300 per transaction. This means that for an investment of ₹10,000, one will have to pay ₹2.

NSE Managing Director and CEO Ashish Chauhan during a media briefing said the introduction of MDR could temporarily affect transaction volumes. "MDR on UPI transactions above ₹2,000 could have a short-term impact on transaction volumes. However, activity is expected to normalise over time as the market adjusts to the new fee structure," he said.

SIP NOT TO SLIP

Industry participants believe the move is unlikely to dent retail participation in mutual funds. Piyush Jhunjunwala, Founder and CEO of Stockify, said investors may explore alternative payment modes but do not expect a significant impact on SIP flows.

"While some investors may consider alternative payment methods when faced with MDR fees, this possibility is not likely to affect SIP investment volumes unless MDR fees become prohibitively high or easily recurrent," Jhunjunwala said. The comments come as SIP investments continue to scale new highs. In August, SIP contributions touched a record ₹32,297 crore, while the total number of SIP accounts crossed 10 crore, translating into an average contribution of around ₹3,230 per account. Jhunjunwala added that investors can easily switch to alternatives such as e-NACH, which enables automated bank debits for recurring investments. "New mandates can be created within a few working days to shift from UPI to bank debits," he said.

LIMITED IMPACT SEEN

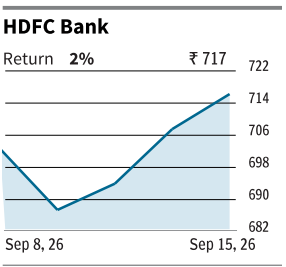
According to Gibin John, Senior Investment Strategist at Geojit Investments, the larger impact may be on intermediaries rather than investors. "If mutual funds are classified under the merchant category, it could increase the cost of processing SIP and lump-sum investments through UPI," he said. John noted that the additional charge would typically be borne by receiving entities such as AMCs rather than investors directly. "As a result, the operating costs of AMCs may increase, which could indirectly affect investors over time," he added. Experts believe the new MDR regime could encourage a gradual shift from UPI to bank-based payment systems for investment transactions, while leaving overall capital market participation largely unaffected.

HDFC Bank shares jump as analysts see clarity emerging on CEO succession

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

HDFC Bank shares surged on Tuesday after the bank moved ahead with its CEO succession process, submitting the names of two candidates to the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) for approval. The stock closed 1.17 per cent higher at ₹716.55 on the NSE, soaring to an intra-day high of ₹730.75 from the previous close of ₹708.25. The stock's movement came after HDFC Bank shortlisted two candidates whose names will be submitted to the RBI for approval to occupy the top position at the bank for three years.

BROKERAGE CALLS Macquarie retained an 'Outperform' rating on HDFC Bank with a target price of ₹1,150, saying an external appointment as MD and CEO could bring a fresh perspective and clean mandate, potentially catalysing a re-rating. Jefferies maintained a 'Buy' rating with a target price of ₹880. It said clarity on smooth succession would be positive for the bank and the sector. Nomura retained a 'Buy' rating with a target price of ₹950. It said an internal appointment could provide initial relief through continuity, while a credible external candidate could offer a longer runway and cleaner slate. An



execution phase and the bank is taking another step towards restoring investor confidence. It favoured a CEO who can provide stability, strategic clarity and a credible roadmap to improve returns. Bernstein maintained an 'Outperform' rating with a target price of ₹1,150. It said the board has submitted two CEO candidates to the RBI for a three-year term and proposed elevating Jimmy Tata as a Whole-Time Director. The new seat takes the total number of whole-time directors to four, while the leadership succession timeline remains on track ahead of the current CEO's retirement.

BROKER'S CALL.

HDFC Securities

CDSL (BUY)
Target: ₹1,620
CMP: ₹1,311

After a soft FY26, in which revenue growth decelerated to 5.8 per cent y-o-y (vs 3Y CAGR of 27 per cent) and EBITDA margin contracted about 651 bps to 51.2 per cent, we believe Central Depository Services (CDSL) is at the cusp of a volume-led growth recovery. The two key headwinds are now behind. The pricing cuts in transaction charges and KYC (create and fetch), which dented KYC blended realisations by about 8-10 per cent, are fully in the base, and the heavy phase of technology and regulatory-led spending has largely played out. Primary market activity has turned decisively, with 50 mainboard IPOs in Q2-FY27 vs nine in Q1-FY27, and BO account additions have recovered to 1 lakh/day from a trough of 70K/day in March 2026. We expect about 1 crore new accounts in Q2-FY27E (58 lakh in Q1FY27), the best quarterly addition in eight quarters. This should revive transaction revenue (almost flat for five quarters), KYC revenue and IPO/corporate action income (+18 per cent y-o-y in FY27E vs -1.9 per cent in FY26), while a widening issuer base compounds the annual issuer charge annuity (around 40 per cent of revenue). The stock has underperformed over the past one year and is presently trading at a 42x FY28E which is about 7 per cent discount to its historical five-year average one-year forward P/E multiple of 45x. This, in our view, prices in the FY26 slowdown but not the recovery. We upgrade CDSL to Buy from Add with a target price of ₹1,620, based on 45x Sep-28E EPS, in line with the 45-55x band the stock has commanded in previous growth-recovery phases.

HSBC Global

JUNIPER GREEN (BUY)
Target: ₹330
CMP: ₹263.80

Juniper Green Energy is a recently listed fast growing renewable energy (RE) independent power producer (IPP) with current installed capacity base of c2GWac. It's one of the smallest listed pure-play renewable energy players but has aggressive growth plans. Juniper Green is a renewable independent power producer (IPP) which develops and operates utility scale renewable energy projects in India and primarily generates revenue through the sale of electricity to various off-takers, including central and State government backed entities. It has signed contracts (PPAs) which are set to deliver additional capacity of 2.7GWac over next two years. Further, it has won letters of award, which when signed into PPAs can result in additional capacity of 3.7GWac resulting in total portfolio capacity of 8.4GWac. We value Juniper Green on a FY28 run-rate EBITDA, which is based on already-signed 25-year PPAs which we expect to be executed by end-FY28. We assign an 11.5x EV/EBITDA target multiple, derived from a base valuation of FY28-end capacity at 9x and 50 per cent probability of maintaining capacity addition run-rate expected over FY26-28. Adjusting for net debt as of March 2028, we derive an equity value of ₹23,100 crore. We discount it back to September 2026 to arrive at a TP of ₹330. **Downside risks:** High leverage with projects financed with an 80-20 debt equity ratio, rise in equipment and borrowing costs, delay in commissioning of contracted capacity, and lower-than-expected generation.

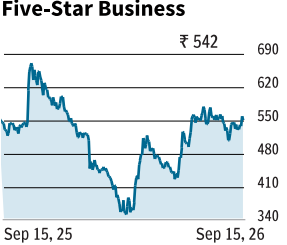
businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: **blmarketwatch@gmail.com**

TODAY'S PICK.

Five-Star Business Finance (₹542.45): BUY

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

The short-term outlook for Five-Star Business Finance is bullish. The stock fell over a per cent on Monday. However, key support levels are at ₹538, ₹525 and ₹510. As such, we see limited downside from here. A fall to ₹525 is a possibility. But the chances of an extended fall to ₹510 are unclear. Ideally, we expect the Five-Star Business Finance share price to reverse higher and rise to ₹615 in the coming weeks. **Traders can buy the stock now at ₹543. Accumulate on dips at ₹532. Keep the stop-loss**



at ₹503. Trail the stop-loss to ₹555 as soon as the stock rises to ₹565. Move the stop-loss higher to ₹570 and ₹585 when the price touches ₹580 and ₹595, respectively. Exit the stock at ₹610. Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

23220 » Nifty 50 Futures

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
23180	23090	23300	23420	Go short on a break below 23180. Keep the stop-loss at 23210

₹717 » HDFC Bank

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
712	705	723	731	Go long on a bounce from 712 with a stop-loss at 710

₹1076 » Infosys

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1070	1050	1085	1100	Take fresh shorts below 1070. Keep the stop-loss at 1075

₹259 » ITC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
258	254	262	264	Go short only below 258. Stop-loss can be kept at 259

₹234 » ONGC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
232	229	236	238	Go short on a break below 232. Keep the stop-loss at 233

₹1239 » Reliance Ind.

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1205	1185	1250	1265	Go short now and at 1245. Keep the stop-loss at 1255

₹973 » SBI

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
967	960	978	985	Take fresh shorts below 967. Keep the stop-loss at 969

₹2264 » TCS

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
2245	2230	2285	2320	Go short now and at 2280. Stop-loss can be kept at 2295

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

SEBI proposes shorter disaster recovery drills

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has proposed shorter disaster recovery (DR) drills and stronger operational resilience measures for market infrastructure institutions (MIIs), including stock exchanges, clearing corporations and depositories. Under the proposal, DR drills would be conducted on non-working days for at least four hours, including the switch from the primary data centre to the disaster recovery site. MIIs would still be required to simulate real-life market conditions, including different market-operation scenarios and loads close to actual participation. "There have been various learnings over time with regard to practices followed by MIIs around conducting DR drills in mock environment, testing and data recovery. On the basis of aforesaid, in

order to increase the operational resilience and ease of compliance by MIIs, additional norms are proposed," SEBI said inviting public comments by October 5. **SYSTEM TESTING** MIIs would have to test not only transaction volumes and orders per second, but also database sizes, tables and other non-transactional components. They would also have to regularly test whether backup components automatically take over if a server, switch or other system component fails. MIIs would also be required to identify and monitor system limits such as database, configuration and table-size limits, improve error logging and maintain a ready reckoner to help interpret errors. For exchanges, SEBI has proposed a framework to recover lost trade data from clearing corporations if data replication at the near site or DRS is affected during a disruption.

Citi's platform to onboard FPIs within 5 days

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai

The time taken by foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) to register in India is set to come down to five business days, as regulators and market intermediaries step up efforts to simplify and digitise the onboarding process. Citigroup has launched eFPI@Citi, a digital onboarding platform that aims to let eligible foreign investors complete registration in five business days. The platform is designed to simplify documentation and reduce the time taken to bring overseas investors into the Indian capital markets. Citi said in the first phase regulated funds from the US, Ireland and Luxembourg will be covered while Singapore, Canada, Australia and the UK planned for the second phase. Citi said its India securities services business has a significant share of the FPI assets under custody.

Nifty 50 Movers						▼ 279.50 pts.
	Close(f)	Pts	PE	WN%		
Infosys	1077.00	30.12	14.41	3.57		
HDFC Bank	716.55	27.77	13.37	10.37		
TCS	2251.00	11.20	16.27	2.17		
HCL Tech	1253.70	10.97	19.51	1.25		
Tech Mahindra	1575.90	4.84	29.91	0.95		
ONGC	235.95	2.93	6.63	0.87		
Hind Unilever	1938.10	2.15	43.39	1.63		
Wipro	170.00	1.54	12.67	0.44		
Tata Steel	183.65	1.17	20.35	1.43		
Tata Motors PV	303.60	1.14	0.00	0.60		
Bharti Airtel	1836.40	-0.47	30.63	5.26		
TataConsumerProduct	886.10	-0.70	59.42	0.61		
Sun Pharma	1835.00	-1.16	36.34	1.84		
Max Healthcare	1030.00	-1.25	68.78	0.72		
Cipla	1351.00	-1.84	32.52	0.72		
Eicher Motors	7452.50	-2.33	35.44	0.97		
Dr Reddy's Lab	1145.00	-2.73	30.02	0.86		
Apollo Hosp	8714.00	-2.74	57.69	0.85		
SBI Life	1654.10	-3.00	63.80	0.70		
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	225.60	-3.08	72.09	0.70		
HDFC Life	516.10	-3.27	56.39	0.52		
NestleIndia	1362.00	-3.34	68.91	0.92		
Coal India	419.25	-3.74	8.28	0.95		
ITC	258.00	-3.90	16.02	2.35		
NTPC	329.50	-4.04	11.28	1.48		
Maruti Suzuki	12231.00	-4.82	26.83	1.51		
Trent Ltd.	2730.00	-5.26	80.22	0.86		
Bajaj Auto	11424.00	-6.15	27.64	1.12		
PowerGrid Corp	262.80	-6.23	15.38	1.20		
Asian Paints	2462.80	-6.89	47.95	1.03		
Hindalco	958.70	-7.21	13.14	1.31		
Bajaj Finserv	1855.50	-7.34	14.39	1.02		
JSW Steel	1229.20	-7.34	10.74	1.09		
UltraTech Cement	10697.00	-7.84	36.78	1.20		
Adani Ports	1713.80	-8.19	30.09	1.20		
Adani Enter	2928.60	-8.29	50.71	0.80		
Grasim Ind	317.00	-9.14	18.96	1.13		
Int'lGlobeAvi	4776.00	-9.74	0.00	1.02		
Eternal Ltd.	315.25	-13.03	702.60	2.15		
Titan	4856.00	-13.85	74.85	1.90		
Axis Bank	1222.90	-14.50	13.61	3.32		
Kotak Bank	409.80	-14.80	20.08	2.85		
Bajaj Finance	1009.20	-14.82	30.43	2.56		
Shriram Finance Ltd.	979.80	-14.93	20.37	1.30		
M&M	3029.50	-15.12	18.61	2.56		
Bharat Elec	382.90	-16.79	45.53	1.30		
L&T	3850.70	-20.46	27.00	4.26		
State Bank	968.00	-25.02	9.97	3.78		
Reliance Ind	1235.30	-32.77	18.96	7.89		
ICI(Bank)	1350.40	-45.24	16.21	9.14		
Pts: Impact on index movement						

Nifty Next 50 Movers						▼ 1,802.55 pts.
	Close(f)	Pts	PE	WN%		
Ltintindtree	4346.60	19.32	24.81	1.67		
Hdfc Amc	2409.00	3.02	35.03	2.03		
AvenueSuper	3680.00	-3.75	78.50	2.45		
Bajaj Holdings	1110.00	-4.28	13.74	1.59		
Britannia Ind	4947.50	-4.96	45.65	2.41		
Tata Power	363.00	-8.00	22.07	2.50		
Indian Hotels Co.	715.00	-8.93	40.68	2.50		
Godrej Consumer	857.90	-9.34	45.83	1.42		
Indian Railway Finance Corp	79.15	-11.34	14.38	0.66		
Tata Capital	353.35	-13.97	27.38	0.74		
Hyundai Motor India .	214.00	-14.09	35.21	1.26		
ZafraLifesciences	1099.00	-14.61	24.08	1.14		
Rundel	324.00	-15.25	5.07	1.07		
CyanoBank	122.37	-15.95	5.60	1.70		
Union Bank	175.00	-17.41	6.47	1.40		
Ambuja Cements	381.75	-18.30	18.29	0.98		
Punjab Nat Bank	114.70	-20.52	5.96	1.63		
United Spirits .	1370.60	-20.55	59.09	1.67		
Ganesh	218.88	-21.48	11.38	1.91		
Hindus Zee	56.90	-21.75	3.89	1.12		
MuthootFin	2722.30	-21.73	9.54	1.21		
Mazagon Dock	2236.00	-22.74	31.60	0.70		
Adani Energy Solutions .	1347.50	-24.34	52.38	1.83		
AdaniGreenenergy	1255.00	-25.65	96.33	1.71		
Shree Cement	1215.00	-25.82	46.31	1.74		
Varun Beverages	409.60	-27.42	40.28	2.32		
Jindal Steel	1095.00	-27.45	41.24	1.68		
Bank of Baroda	232.70	-29.28	6.54	1.79		
Vedanta	350.00	-33.02	6.02	1.80		
Bosch	47070.00	-33.15	58.75	1.69		
Indian Oilcorp	132.03	-34.93	5.22	2.04		
Bajaj	620.85	-34.45	24.85	1.95		
Siemens Energy India .	3028.70	-39.22	72.49	1.11		
Power Finance	344.00	-39.99	3.37	2.07		
Abb India	7005.00	-41.02	95.45	1.52		
Pidclitind	1521.10	-41.24	57.58	1.95		
McQuayNorton Developers .	1064.80	-42.00	25.77	1.22		
Divis Lab	47.00	-44.09	34.75	1.65		
Tata Motors Cv	427.15	-44.91	37.57	3.69		
Divis Lab	9198.00	-48.50	83.48	4.83		
Siemens	3750.00	-48.04	92.41	3.38		
Torrent Pharma	450.00	-49.24	85.57	2.94		
Tes Motor Corp .	4050.00	-51.20	53.43	3.93		
Siemens HealthineersFin	68.00	-68.27	28.89	2.20		
Cummins India	4674.00	-76.94	57.08	2.72		
SandarmotorsInternationalat	18.15	-80.88	36.64	2.89		
Adani Power .	202.00	-86.10	26.81	3.47		
Cg Power & Ind Sol	455.00	-101.63	109.14	2.43		
HindustanIneronautics	869.00	-115.77	33.68	3.68		
Polar Industries	1925.00	-215.20	84.96	1.94		
Pts: Impact on index movement						

QUICKLY.

TCS, DGCX tie up for derivatives market infra



Mumbai: Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) has partnered with the Dubai Gold & Commodities Exchange (DGCX) to modernise and future-proof the latter's market infrastructure through a next-generation integrated trading, clearing and surveillance solution. The transformation programme will strengthen DGCX's ability to respond to the evolving needs of regional and international market participants across established and emerging asset classes. **OUR BUREAU**

Vi fined ₹2 lakh for not meeting service quality

Mumbai: Telecom regulator TRAI ordered a fee of ₹2 lakh upon Vodafone Idea (Vi) for failing with the quality of services in different regions in October 2025. "Pursuant to SEBI Listing Regulations, [Vi] hereby submit the details of order issued to the company by the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India under Standards of Quality of Service of Access (Wireline and Wireless) and Broadband (Wireline and Wireless) Service Regulations, 2024," said Vi in a stock exchange filing. **OUR BUREAU**

Madras Sanskrit College and Articul8 AI launch model to make Sanskrit searchable

OLD AND NEW. AI tool should not just restore Sanskrit to its 'old glory', but anchor its knowledge for future generations: FM Sitharaman

Rohan Das
Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

Ask AI about management, and chances are that you will get a lesson out of western management theory.

Ask about medicine, and it will throw up allopathic remedies. AI now provides knowledge at our fingertips, but rarely do the solutions lean on ancient Indian wisdom and heritage.

To address this, The Madras Sanskrit College (MSC) here, along with the US-based generative AI start-up Articul8 AI, launched a Sanskrit Heritage Model and Platform on Tuesday. The family of AI models called Laya, which has been developed on large volume of Sanskrit books and data from MSC alongside other publicly-available documents, was launched by Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman at an event here.

Speaking at the launch event, Sitharaman said that Sanskrit's precision and structured grammar gave it a natural advantage in the AI era. Even 3,000, 4,000 years ago, Sanskrit was built by scholars who knew to arrive at precision and that makes it particularly suited to tech applications, she said. "Knowledge is now so intricately woven with technology



NEW INITIATIVE. (from left) Ramesh Mahalingam, Trustee, The Madras Sanskrit College; S Ramadorai, former Chairman, TCS; Nirmala Sitharaman, Finance Minister; N Gopalswamy, former CEC and President, VKISET Trust; and Arun K Subramaniyan, CEO, Articul8 AI India, at the launch of Sanskrit Heritage Model and Platform in Chennai on Tuesday **BIJOY GHOSH**

that you really cannot be without it," she added.

'OLD GLORY'

Sitharaman said the objective of such an AI tool should not just be to restore Sanskrit to its "old glory", but to anchor its knowledge and influence for future generations.

She also urged Articul8 to use the technology to document Sanskrit's influence beyond India.

Currently, the model is being fine-tuned by a team of 10-15 scholars from MSC

who have spent time testing, interpreting and validating its responses. It is set to be first released to a select group of institutions, and a series of public releases are also planned in the coming weeks.

"If we are able to understand Sanskrit from the deep meaning of the language, as the designers of the language intended, then you can use that understanding to mine for information in various domains that has now been lost," Arun K Subramaniyan, Founder and CEO, Articul8

AI, told *businessline*, explaining the motivation for the tool.

KEY DIFFERENCE

The key difference in Laya's approach is that unlike a general purpose AI model that relies on abridged or translated version of Sanskrit training data, Articul8 AI has built the model from the bottom up incorporating the rich grammatical rules of the language, he added.

Articul8 AI's platform also achieves all this with a more

efficient 'tokenomics' than general purpose models.

"If you use an LLM with an Indic language, you end up spending three-five times more tokens than you do with English for the same information. With our tokenizer, we are 17 times more efficient. So you need less tokens, not more," Subramaniyan said.

Laya's "correctness stack" allows the AI system to check responses against the various rules of Sanskrit instead of just predicting the next word based on patterns of

Current account deficit more than doubles to \$7 billion in July

Press Trust of India
Mumbai

India's current account deficit widened to \$7 billion in July from \$3.2 billion a year ago, mainly due to a higher merchandise trade deficit, according to the Reserve Bank of India data released on Tuesday. The preliminary data on India's balance of payments for July 2026 released by the central bank showed that the merchandise trade deficit rose to \$31.7 billion in July from \$28.2 billion in the same month last year. Imports increased to \$76.8 billion (\$65.6 billion), while exports rose to \$45.1 billion (\$37.4 billion).

OTHER IMPROVEMENTS

On the other hand, there was improvement in net services surplus, which increased to \$17.6 billion (\$16.4 billion). Services exports stood at \$38.3 billion, while imports totalled \$20.6 billion during the month under review.

Net transfers increased to \$13.2 billion (\$12.6 billion), while net income outgo widened to \$6.1 billion (\$4 billion). The capital account recorded a net inflow of \$27.7 billion, sharply higher than \$3.5 billion last year. Net foreign direct investment inflows rose to \$7.3 billion (\$4.5 billion). The overall balance stood at a surplus of \$20.8 billion in July 2026 (\$0.3 billion). For the April-July period of 2026-27, the current account deficit stood at \$11.2 billion.

RCom's creditors request ED to release real estate properties worth ₹7,000 crore

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Reliance Communications' (RCom) Committee of Creditors (CoC) has asked the Enforcement Directorate (ED) and the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India to release the company's real estate properties worth ₹7,000 crore, following the Supreme Court's rejection of the spectrum insolvency plea. The creditors are likely to meet this week to deliberate on further resolution possibilities, according to the information accessed by *businessline*.

Shortly after the Supreme Court refused to reconsider spectrum as an asset under the insolvency code, the Committee, led by SBI, is seeking to preserve and unlock the value of the company's remaining assets—particularly its real estate portfolio. This includes 132.07 acres at Dhirubhai Ambani Knowledge City (DAKC) in Navi Mumbai, valued at ₹4,462.81 crore, which was attached by the ED last year. Accounting for other attached real estate properties in Delhi, Chennai, Pune and Odisha, the total value of attached assets is estimated to exceed ₹7,000

Real estate has assumed an important role in RCom's resolution, particularly after the exclusion of spectrum from the insolvency pool

crore. Real estate has assumed an important role in RCom's resolution, particularly after the exclusion of spectrum from the insolvency pool.

The original resolution plan estimated recoveries of over ₹23,000 crore for 38 lenders against secured debt of approximately ₹33,000 crore. For the highest bidder of the company's core assets, UV Asset Reconstruction Company Ltd (UVARCL), spectrum accounted for more than half of the proposed consideration of approximately ₹14,000 crore.

NEW RESOLUTION PLAN

With that asset no longer available, the property portfolio is to be one of the principal sources of value for creditors to support a new resolution plan or generate recoveries through liquidation. However, a significant portion of the real estate has

Kamarajar Port initiates plans for ₹1,200 cr IPO

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai

Kamarajar Port Ltd (KPL), a wholly-owned subsidiary of the Chennai Port Authority, has taken one more step towards tapping the capital markets.

The IPO is structured as an Offer for Sale with an estimated issue size of ₹1,200 crore and KPL has released a request for proposal (RFP) to engage a domestic legal counsel (DLC).

The final structure is subject to board and shareholder approval, says the RFP document issued on Tuesday.

The DLC will manage end-to-end legal and secretarial due diligence, draft key offer documents — including the Draft Red Herring Prospectus and Prospectus, advise on publicity restrictions, handle regulatory filings with SEBI and stock exchanges, and draft transaction-related agreements.

Rupee turns weak, dollar gains momentum

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

The rupee came under pressure over the past week, depreciating about 1.2 per cent to close at 95.96 against the dollar on Tuesday. The weakness was driven by persistent foreign outflows, higher US bond yields and renewed geopolitical tensions that lifted crude oil prices.

WEEKLY RUPEE VIEW.

According to NSDL data, net FPI outflows stood at about \$1.03 billion over the past week, taking cumulative outflows in September to about \$2.5 billion. The sustained selling by overseas investors has added pressure on the local currency.

The external environment has also turned less favourable. US consumer price data for August showed headline inflation unchanged at 3.4 per cent, while core inflation

rose 0.3 per cent month-on-month, above market expectations and the strongest increase since early 2021. The data increased expectations that the Federal Reserve could raise rates soon.

The impact was visible in the bond market. The US 10-year Treasury yield briefly touched 5.04 per cent on Tuesday, its highest level since 2023. Higher Treasury yields enhance the attractiveness of dollar-denominated assets, encouraging capital flows into the US and weighing on the rupee.

Meanwhile, geopolitical tensions continue to keep crude oil prices elevated. Saudi Arabia shut its East-West pipeline, an alternative route to the Strait of Hormuz, following drone attacks last Thursday. The development has heightened concerns over energy supplies, supporting Brent crude prices and adding more pressure on the rupee. Brent crude (now at \$106.50/barrel), which gained 8.7 per



cent last week, is up nearly 2 per cent so far this week.

Overall, the combination of higher US yields, persistent FPI outflows and elevated crude oil prices has weakened the rupee further.

WHAT THE CHARTS SAY

The rupee has seen a sharp fall over the last week. It slipped below both 21- and 50-day moving average. On Tuesday, it breached an important support at 95.80, opening the door for further decline.

Although there is a chance for a temporary relief where the local currency can rise to 95.40-95.60, it is likely to eventually fall further from

the current level, possibly to 96.25 or to 96.50. That said, in case the rupee can surpass 95.40, it can appreciate to 95.20. However, as it stands, the bias is bearish. This is substantiated by a renewed traction in the dollar.

The dollar index rebounded from the support at 98.60 for the second time in the last one month. Currently trading at 99.60, if the index surpasses the nearest resistance at 99.80, a double-bottom chart pattern will be confirmed. This can lead to a quick rally to 101, a resistance. Subsequent resistance is at 101.60. As per charts, the rupee shows bearish inclination and the dollar is gaining momentum.

BEARISH OUTLOOK

The near-term outlook has turned bearish following the breakdown below 95.80. While a brief recovery towards 95.40-95.60 cannot be ruled out, the broader trend points to further weakness towards 96.25-96.50.

AP METRO RAIL CORPORATION LIMITED, VIJAYAWADA
Rc.No.14/Admn/APMRC/2026, Dated 11-09-2026.

NOTIFICATION

Ap Metro Rail Corporation Ltd. invites applications from eligible candidates with requisite qualifications and experience for suitable posts, viz., Director (Finance), Chief Vigilance & Security Officer, Trainee Engineers and DAO/IO. The details are available in website: <https://amrc.ap.gov.in>

Sd/- N.P. Ramakrishna Reddy, Managing Director

Malabar Regional Co-operative Milk Producers' Union Ltd.
Head Office: Kunnamangalam, Kozhikode 673571, Kerala, Ph: 0495-2805433, Website: www.mrcmpu.com

MRU: PER: 47/ 2026-27
SECURITY CONTRACT SERVICE E-TENDER

Malabar Regional Co-operative Milk Producers' Union Ltd. (MRCMPU Ltd or Malabar Milma or Union). Invite competitive offers from reputed and licensed security service providers for undertaking the security service by deploying security personnel on piece rate, principal to principal, independent labour contract basis for the various units of MRCMPU Ltd for a period of one year from 00.00 Hrs of 01.11.2026. For more details, Please contact-8606421026. e-tender website: www.etenders.kerala.gov.in. Tender Id:2026_KCMMF_869922_1 (Sd/- Managing Director)

MCL MAHANADI COALFIELDS LIMITED
(A Subsidiary of Coal India Limited)
JAGRUTI VIHAR, BURLA-768020, DIST : SAMBALPUR (ODISHA)
Tel. Phone (EPABX) : 0663-2542461 to 469, Website : www.mahanadicoal.in

Notice

"All the tenders issued by CIL and its Subsidiaries for procurement of Goods, Works and Services are available on websites of Coal India Ltd. www.coalindia.in, respective Subsidiary Company (MCL, www.mahanadicoal.in), CIL e-procurement portal <https://coalindiatenders.nic.in> and Central Public Procurement Portal <https://eprocure.gov.in> in addition, procurement is also done through GeM Portal <https://gem.gov.in>". **R-5312**

MALABAR CEMENTS LIMITED
(A Government of Kerala Undertaking)
An ISO 9001:2015, 14001:2015 Company, Walyar Post, Palakkad - 678624 - Kerala
Email : bulkmcl@malabarcentments.com / materials@malabarcentments.com

TENDER NOTICE

Visit www.etenders.kerala.gov.in for Online Submission of Bids for:
✦Design and engineering, manufacture and supply, installation, erection and commissioning of multi channel and multifuel burner and additional coalmill bag filter including civil foundation and supporting structures at MCL Walyar on turnkey basis. ✦ For undertaking the contract work of silo extraction, packing and loading of cement into trucks, tarpaulin covering and tying and unloading/ loading of raw materials, stores and spares etc. as detailed in the tender document. ✦ Supply of lifter plate.
Visit www.mstcecommerce.com for E-Auction for: ✦ Disposal of MS/CJ/GU/CS and Liner Plates Scrap Items at MCL, Walyar. ✦ Disposal of Scrap Aluminium Power Cables at MCL, Walyar. **Sd/- MANAGING DIRECTOR**

PUDUCHERRY DISTILLERIES LIMITED
(A Govt. of Puducherry Undertaking)
Ariyapalayam, Puducherry - 605 110.
Tel: 0413-2666844 / 2667578
Email: pd@pdindia.in , pd@py.gov.in

E-TENDER NOTICE

Tender ID: 2026_PDL_22851_1 Date: 12-09-2026
E-tenders are invited from established manufacturers/suppliers for the "Supply of Aluminium Caps 25 mm PP cap" through e-procurement portal (<https://pudutenders.gov.in>) only. Tender Fee of Rs.2,500/- and EMD for amount of Rs.4,00,000/- are to be paid through Internet Banking or NEFT/RTGS mode only. Last date and time of Submission of bids online is 07-10-2026 at 12.00 P.M. For detailed information and Terms and Conditions please refer tenders online through e-procurement portal <https://pudutenders.gov.in>. The Tender details, and Terms and Conditions may also be downloaded from the website www.py.gov.in and <https://pdindia.in> for reference only.
ABBU: E3/2026 MANAGING DIRECTOR

TATA TATA POWER
(Corporate Contracts Department)
Sahar Receiving Station, Near Hotel Lesia, Andhri (E), Mumbai 400 059, Maharashtra, India
(Board Line: 022-67173188) CIN: L28920MH1919PLC000567

NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST

The Tata Power Company Limited hereby invites Expression of Interest for following Packages at Shirawta:

- Supply and Supervision services of erection, testing & commissioning of MV Switchgears and its accessories – CC27PP013
- Erection, Testing and Commissioning Package for Electrical Works – Ref No: CC27FK026.

For details of requirement, please visit Tender section of our website (URL: <https://www.tatapower.com/tender>). Eligible vendors willing to participate may submit their expression of interest along with tender fee latest by 23rd September 2026.

AMARA RAJA | ENERGY & MOBILITY

Amara Raja Energy & Mobility Limited
CIN: L31402AP1985PLC005305

Registered office: Renigunta-Cuddapah Road, Karakambadi, Tirupati, Andhra Pradesh, India-517520.
Corporate Office: Terminal A, 1-18/1/AMR/NR, Nanakramguda, Gachibowli, Hyderabad - 500032.
E-mail id: investorservices@amararaja.com | **Website:** www.amararajaeandm.com
Tel: 91 (40) 23139000 | **Fax:** 91 (40) 23139001

NOTICE TO SHAREHOLDERS

SPECIAL WINDOW FOR THE RE-LODGE MENT OF TRANSFER REQUESTS OF PHYSICAL SHARES

In terms of SEBI Circular No. HO/38/13/11(2)2026-MIRSD-POD/ 1/3750/2026 dated January 30, 2026 on the above referred subject matter, please note that the Special Window for re-lodgment of physical share transfer deeds of Amara Raja Energy & Mobility Limited is open for a period of one year from February 05, 2026 to February 04, 2027.

The facility is available only if the transfer deeds, for sale/purchase of physical securities, were lodged prior to April 01, 2019, and were rejected/ returned/not attended to, due to deficiency in the documents/process/or otherwise. For clarity on this, please refer to the below matrix:

Execution Date of Transfer Deed	Lodged for transfer before April 01, 2019?	Original Security Certificate Available?	Eligible to Lodge in the current window?
Before April 01, 2019	No (It is fresh lodgement)	Yes	✓
Before April 01, 2019	Yes (It was rejected/returned earlier)	Yes	✓
Before April 01, 2019	Yes	No	✗
Before April 01, 2019	No	No	✗

In case you wish to avail this opportunity, please contact the Company's Registrar and Transfer Agent (RTA) – M/s. Cameo Corporate Services Limited (Unit: Amara Raja Energy & Mobility Limited), Mr. P. Muralidharan, Manager, Subramanian Building, No.1, Club House Road, Chennai - 600 002, Phone: 044 - 4002 0700, e-mail at investor@cameoindia.com. Shareholders can also upload the documents on the mentioned portal: <https://wisdom.cameoindia.com/>. Further, Shareholder may contact the Company at investorservices@amararaja.com for any support.

The above-referred shares that are re-lodged for transfer, if approved, will be issued by the Company only in demat mode.

For further information, please refer to the link for SEBI Circular on https://www.sebi.gov.in/legal/circulars/jan-2026/ease-of-doing-investment-special-window-for-transfer-and-dematerialisation-of-physical-securities_99411.html

For Amara Raja Energy & Mobility Limited

Place: Hyderabad
Date: September 15, 2026

Sd/-
Vikas Sabharwal
Company Secretary & General Counsel

Oracle layoffs underscore shift from hiring at scale to AI-led productivity

SKILLS MATTER. AI is changing hiring priorities, favouring specialised skills over large technology workforces

Sanjana B
Bengaluru

Oracle's latest round of lay-offs highlights a broader shift in the technology industry, where companies are increasingly using AI and automation to raise productivity without expanding their workforces at the same pace, industry experts said.

The exact number of employees affected in India in the latest round is currently unknown. Oracle began another round of job cuts on September 14, with social media posts indicating that affected employees in the US lost access to company systems before receiving termination emails at around 6 am.

The latest layoffs follow a much larger round in March, when Oracle cut tens of thousands of jobs globally as it re-



AI HEADWINDS. Oracle's latest layoffs follow March's larger global job cuts amid its cloud and AI investments REUTERS

structured its workforce while investing in cloud and AI infrastructure.

AI IMPACT
Praveen Bhadada, CEO and MD of Neovay Global, said, "While Oracle's layoffs are about AI, they are also about building a leaner organisation for future resilience amid considerable uncertainty in the technology industry."

He said software engineering, testing and support were among the areas where AI

was already delivering productivity gains, leading to reductions in such roles across technology companies.

BROADER SHIFT
At the same time, demand is expected to remain strong for skills in AI, data, cloud and security, including forward-deployed engineers (FDEs). He added that while technology spending is far from slowing down, its correlation to headcount is fading away. Aditya Narayan Mishra, MD and

CEO of CIEL HR, said Oracle's latest cuts reflect a broader workforce shift.

"Oracle's latest layoffs are an indication of a larger shift in how technology companies are thinking about workforce productivity, but I would be cautious about attributing every job cut directly to AI. Layoffs are a result of a combination of AI-led productivity gains, cost discipline, business restructuring and a significant reallocation of capital towards cloud and AI infrastructure."

According to Mishra, the pressure is visible in roles such as software engineering, testing, technical support, project management and technical staff, where portions of the work can be automated or augmented by AI. The change is also altering the traditional relationship between technology invest-

ment and employment, Mishra said.

"Earlier, scaling technology capabilities often meant adding more people; today, companies can invest in AI, cloud and automation and increase output without expanding the workforce. The overall tech workforce may grow slowly, but the value and complexity of work delivered per employee is increasing rapidly."

The shift could also reshape India's GCC ecosystem. Bhadada said more than half of Indian GCCs still operate as back offices handling lower-maturity work, making them exposed to AI-led automation. He said more than 25 GCCs had been shut down, had reduced headcount or were taken over by service providers last year, and expected more than 50 to face a similar fate this year.

India's semiconductor sector raises \$1.4 b, half of it since 2025: Tracxn

Sanjana B
Bengaluru

India's semiconductor sector is home to 3,557 companies, of which 142 have raised equity funding (out of 281 funded companies), totaling \$1.4 billion to date according to Tracxn Technologies' *Semiconductors - India Report*.

The semiconductor sector has raised \$1.4 billion in all-time equity funding, with half of it arriving since 2025. Of the 3,557 companies tracked, 281 have raised funding, including 142 equity-funded ones.

ILJIN Electronics raised the highest of \$198 million PE round, followed by Tessolve Semiconductor's \$150 million PE round.

While overall funding has grown steadily over recent years, business-model level data shows a rotation away from Electronic Manufacturing Services toward Fabless Semiconductor Manufactur-



CHIP DEALS. India's semiconductor sector saw 62 acquisitions as of 2026 YTD compared with 42 IPOs

ing and Embedded Hardware. The report also examines the sector's funding trends, investor activity, exits, and geographic concentration.

TOP MODEL
Electronic Manufacturing Services has been the sector's top-funded business model raising \$313 million since 2025. Embedded Hardware ranks second with \$51.9 million raised since

2025, entirely in the trailing 12 months. Other leading models include Power Management Integrated Circuits and Fabless Semiconductor Manufacturers.

Bengaluru hosts 626 of India's 3,557 semiconductor companies, about 18 per cent of the total, and accounts for 40.1 per cent of all equity funding raised to date. Noida, Gurugram, Kochi and Hyderabad follow at a distance.

KEY PLAYERS
Key players behind Bengaluru's dominance include Tessolve Semiconductor, Coreel, and C2I Semiconductors.

The report also observed that India's semiconductor sector has recorded 62 acquisitions as of 2026 YTD compared with 42 IPOs. The largest exit on record is eIn-fochips' \$282 million acquisition.

Recent companies to go public include Tempens Instruments and Merritronix.

AISATS personnel under scanner over Air India hub-and-spoke immigration lapse

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

Personnel of ground-handling agency AISATS are under scrutiny in the ongoing investigation into the immigration lapse involving three Italian nationals who travelled from Amritsar via Delhi to Munich without mandatory departure immigration clearance, sources told *businessline*.

As per sources, they were responsible for guiding domestic and international passengers to the designated gates, as applicable.

They have been suspended pending the investigation, another source said. When contacted, the

ground-handling agency, a joint venture between Air India and SATS, did not respond to queries.

Meanwhile, authorities have initiated a review of existing procedures to strengthen the security mechanism for hub-and-spoke operations.

The development follows a show-cause notice issued by the Ministry of Civil Aviation to Air India on September 12 over what it termed a "serious security and immigration-related lapse". The Centre had also summoned the airline's CEO, sources said.

Sources told *businessline* that an initial report and information indicated lapses in the ground-handling pro-

cess. The passengers' boarding cards carried a "D" marking, identifying them as domestic passengers on the Amritsar-Delhi leg.

Accordingly, they should have been directed through domestic arrivals and then proceeded to international departures to complete immigration formalities before boarding their onward flight.

However, sources said the passengers were allegedly routed through the international-to-international (I2I) transfer process instead of the domestic-to-international (D2I) process.

This allowed them direct access to the Lufthansa counter for their onward journey, bypassing departure immigration checks.

Mobile number portability row hints at shift in market dynamics

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

The recent conflict between leading telcos Bharti Airtel, Reliance Jio, and Vodafone Idea (Vi) regarding mobile number portability tactics strongly indicates a change in market dynamics, moving away from the assumed duopoly, according to experts.

Leading telecom companies Airtel and Jio recently wrote to the sector watchdog, the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI), alleging that the third telecom service provider (TSP), Vi, attempted to poach users to its network by offering special plans and hindering the porting-out process by blocking SMS messages.

Sources familiar with the



Airtel and Jio wrote to TRAI, alleging that Vi attempted to poach users to its network by offering special plans

situation said that the call recordings shared in the matter may prove ineffective in terms of the claims. However, TRAI has stated that it will consider the grievances and has directed Vi to conduct an internal review ac-

cordingly. More interesting than the allegations, experts following the development said the letter hints at an interesting change in the telco ecosystem.

"People believed that Vi is far too entangled in legal hassles. Now, it has gotten a breather and can pivot away from defensive tactics. Other companies know they can't ignore Vi anymore," said Faisal Kawoosa, Chief Analyst and Founder of Techarc.

LEGAL STAND
When asked whether Vi has, in fact, flouted regulations by trying to onboard rival companies' customers, Naqeeb Ahmed Kazia, Partner at CMS Induslaw, said, "MNP is designed to allow subscribers to switch between

networks. As a result, chasing a competitor's customer is permitted and not illegal."

However, a telco is not permitted to offer differential pricing to subscribers if they were to port to its network.

This means that if Vi is found in contravention of TRAI regulations, the regulator will order the withdrawal or modification of the contravening plans, direct the TSP to report all tariff plans to TRAI, and possibly impose a monetary penalty. According to Mahesh Uppal, Director of Comm First (India), the penalty would not be of major consequence.

However, a TRAI decision in 2021 prohibits blocking or delaying porting. At the time, TRAI stated that all telecom operators must allow cus-

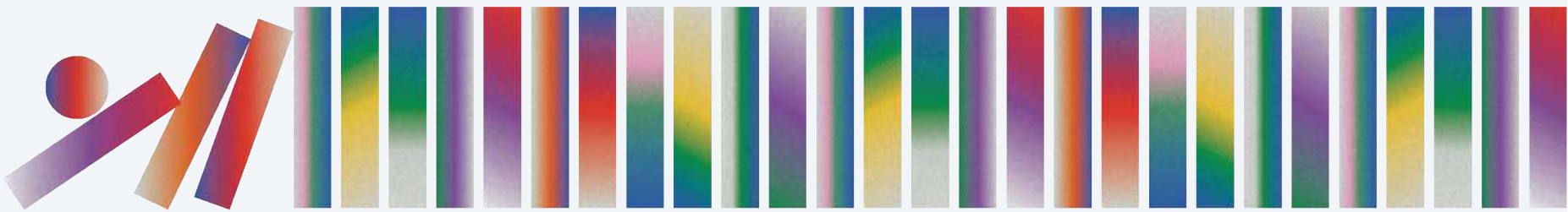
tomers to send and receive SMSes during porting procedures.

Interestingly, this decision was also borne out of a complaint by Jio against Vi for removing SMS from its ₹99 base-level plan.

This means that a telco cannot refuse a valid port-out under the MNP regulations. If a subscriber is leaving, the telco must let them send the SMS to 1900 and issue the Unique Porting Code (UPC) without delay, on a non-discriminatory basis.

"So, if Vi is shown to have throttled or delayed the SMS or the UPC in some circles, that would prima facie breach these rules," said Kazia, adding that TRAI could order corrective steps for the affected subscribers and impose a penalty on Vi.

CELEBRATING THE QUIET DREAMERS WHO DRIVE POWERFUL CHANGE.



They are the visionaries who dream quietly and act with intent. Their steady pursuit of progress turns belief into action, and action into a future we can all look forward to.

The Hindu businessline Changemaker Awards 2026 celebrates these leaders of change, recognising the ones who challenge the ordinary and set in motion ripples that transform lives and communities.

Join us live as we applaud the changemakers shaping tomorrow.



CHIEF GUEST

Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman

Honourable Minister of Finance and Corporate Affairs, Government of India



Scan the QR code or visit thbl.news/BLCM2026 to subscribe and watch the event.

SASTRA
DEEMED UNIVERSITY
THANJAVUR - KUMBakonam - CHENNAI

Presents

thehindu**businessline.**



CHANGE
MAKER
awards RECOGNISING HUMAN CATALYSTS

Powered by

CITY UNION BANK

September 22 | 6 pm onwards | New Delhi

Presenting Partner

SASTRA
DEEMED UNIVERSITY
THANJAVUR - KUMBakonam - CHENNAI

Powered by

CITY UNION BANK

Associate Partners

SBI
The banker to every Indian

APIC
The Future is Here

CITIZEN

J&K Bank
Serving To Empower

NABARD

एनटीपीसी NTPC

भारतीय बैंक Indian Bank
आपका अपना बैंक, हर क्षण आपके साथ
YOUR OWN BANK, ALWAYS WITH YOU

सेल SAIL

गैल GAIL

ESSAR

ICFAI GROUP

एनएमडीसी NMDC

Mobility Partner

Kia Sorento

QUICKLY.

Zetwerk expands
factory capabilities

Bengaluru: IPO-bound Zetwerk is becoming more factory-heavy even as it continues to position itself as an asset-light manufacturing platform, with three facilities under construction as it scales capacity across power, renewable energy, electronics and other industrial segments, as per its UDRHP. Two of its newer facilities, a transformer plant at Savli in Gujarat and a CRGO laminations and cores facility at Kherdi in Dadra & Nagar Haveli, became operational in July 2026.

OUR BUREAU

MIC Electronics sets up
defence, aerospace arm

Hyderabad: MIC Electronics Ltd, an LED display solutions and intelligent communication systems provider, has set up a wholly-owned subsidiary, MIC Defence Systems Pvt Ltd, to focus on defence electronics, unmanned systems, surveillance, electronic warfare, AI-based defence technologies and cybersecurity.

OUR BUREAU

DRDO hands over nine tech transfer deals to private sector at VIMARSH

LARGER ROLE. Ties with industry should expand across the entire value chain, says Defence Minister

Dalip Singh
New Delhi

The Defence Ministry handed over nine licensing agreements for transfer of technology to 13 manufacturing partners on Tuesday to enable commercial production of systems developed by different labs of the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO).

Defence PSU Bharat Dynamics Ltd (BDL) will co-produce the “multi-influence ground mine” for the Navy to target modern ships and submarines along with Hyderabad-based Apollo Micro Systems Ltd. Both companies had participated in the development by manufacturing components like electronic systems and resistance outer casing for the mine.

The handing over was done by Defence Minister Rajnath Singh during ‘VIMARSH’, a DRDO-industry

synergy meet, which unveiled policy initiatives to lower technical and financial entry barriers for MSMEs and deep-tech start-ups, offer funding, incubation support and dedicated access to DRDO testing facilities, the Ministry of Defence said in a statement.

Three private explosive manufacturing companies — Solar defence & Aerospace Ltd, Premier Explosives Pvt Ltd and Salvo Industries Pvt Ltd — have been selected for the production of propellant and igniter for booster and sustainer motors of the short range anti-ship missile.

PROGRESS MADE

Similarly, the DRDO has selected Ananth Technologies Pvt Ltd and Apollo Micro Systems Ltd for the production of a semi-active homing laser system, widely used in precision-guided munitions (such as laser-guided bombs, missiles and artillery shells).

In some cases, the com-



EXPANDING CAPABILITIES. Defence Minister Rajnath Singh and DRDO chief Rajesh Kumar Singh at the meet in New Delhi

panies have already advanced in the process of manufacturing products.

For instance, JCBL Pvt Ltd had announced in February that the indigenous 20-tonne heavy drop system, developed by the ADRDE lab of the DRDO, has been validated by the Army. The company figured in Tuesday’s announcement of technology transfer for heavy drop systems for C-130 Hercules and C-17 Globemaster strategic transporter aircraft operated by the Air Force.

Others selected are Autotec Systems Pvt Ltd and

Accelor Microsystems for an electronic activation device that allows operators or on-board fire-control systems to program variable delays, airburst heights or target-specific detonation profiles prior to launch.

Both companies have also been chosen for the wireless control-cum-actuation system to remotely operate, control and detonate explosive payloads, warheads or demolition devices.

Billwin Industries Ltd and Uflow Automation will manufacture Hydro Suit, Ants Innovations Pvt Ltd for ZnTe

Gem, jewellery exports up 3% to \$2.30 billion in Aug

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

Gem and jewellery exports increased 3 per cent in August to \$2.3 billion, compared with \$2.23 billion in the same period last year, driven by a rise in value-added gold jewellery exports.

In rupee terms, exports increased 13 per cent to ₹21,946 crore from ₹19,504 crore due to the depreciation of the rupee, according to data from the Gem and Jewellery Export Promotion Council.

While cut and polished

diamond exports remained under pressure in value terms, the volume rose from 12.94 lakh carats in August 2025 to 13.36 lakh carats in August 2026.

At the same time, studded gold jewellery exports surged 52 per cent in US dollar terms, indicating growing international demand for finished and value-added jewellery.

Plain gold jewellery exports declined 24 per cent to \$357 million, amid elevated gold prices and the limited availability of duty-free gold for exporters, raising input



EXPORT BOOST. Cut, polished diamond export volume rose to 13.36 lakh carats in August from 12.94 lakh carats a year ago

costs and putting pressure on the competitiveness of plain gold jewellery exports.

FINISHED JEWELLERY

Gold prices increased 8 per cent month-on-month to

\$4,074 per troy ounce in July to \$4,411 per troy ounce in August. Kirit Bhansali, Chairman, GJEP, said, “The increase in diamond export volumes, along with the sharp growth in studded gold

jewellery exports, highlights India’s growing ability to create greater value by transforming precious materials into finished jewellery.”

Cut and polished diamond exports declined 5 per cent to \$925 million. Silver jewellery exports declined 40 per cent to \$87 million. Polished lab-grown diamonds exports grew 28 per cent to \$125 million.

Gem and jewellery exports increased 3 per cent at \$11.47 billion, while in rupee terms, exports rose 13 per cent to ₹1.09 lakh crore, despite continued global eco-

nomie uncertainties and elevated precious metal prices. Gold jewellery exports increased 7 per cent to \$5 billion (\$4.7 billion) year-on-year. Cut and polished diamond exports declined 7 per cent \$4.52 billion during April-August.

Silver jewellery exports grew 36 per cent to \$595 million (\$439 million).

Polished lab-grown diamond exports increased 12 per cent to \$534 million (\$478 million). Coloured gemstone exports declined 2 per cent to \$153 million (\$156 million).

Use AI to streamline formal vehicle scrappage ecosystem, say auto OEMs

Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad

Customer documentation, an unorganised intermediary network and a convenience deficit are hobbling the vehicle scrappage ecosystem, industry executives said on Tuesday, pitching artificial intelligence (AI) as the key driver to clean up the sector.

Speaking at a panel discussion during the World Circular Economy Forum 2026 in Gandhinagar, leaders from Tata Motors and Mahindra & Mahindra outlined the operational bottlenecks holding back Registered Vehicle Scrappage Facilities.

Highlighting the massive market for domestic recycling, MS Anand Kumar, AVP and Head at TVS Motor Company, said vehicles manufactured between 2005 and 2023 hold an estimated 98 million tonnes of recoverable steel.

“AI has an opportunity in the Indian vehicle scrappage context. It is a fragmented industry with thousands of players, largely informal, and there is a large pool of vehicles that needs to be replaced,” said Prasad Phadke, Senior General Manager at Tata Motors Ltd.

Despite scaling infrastructure, such as Tata Motors’ ‘Rewire’ network operating around 12 facilities with capacity exceeding 2 lakh dismantlings annually, formal centres struggle to attract end-of-life vehicles. “Today, there is greater inconvenience and hence reluctance from customers to come to a registered facility,” Phadke noted. “They probably end up scrapping at a nearby centre that is unregistered.”

He said AI algorithms could be used to locate ageing vehicles, deploy automated customer outreach, assist in retrieving missing paper trails, and automate

government registry compliance. Similarly, on-site AI and vision systems could prioritise inbound vehicle streams, track stored components and identify material compositions to unlock site efficiencies.

FOR CIRCULARITY

Senthilkumaran Varatharajan, Senior General Manager at Mahindra & Mahindra, cautioned that circularity must begin on the drawing board. He highlighted that data harvested by AI during dismantling, such as corrosion rates, reusable parts, and hazardous substances like brominated polymers or chromium, must be fed back into OEM design loops to extend product longevity and refine material standards.

He pointed to severe supply constraints for recycled materials. “AI in dismantling networks can offer real-time data on supply quantity and quality,” he added.

CSL, Drydocks World sign pact for ship repair facility

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

Dubai-headquartered Drydocks World sees more opportunities for investment in ship repair and fabrication facilities in India, CEO Captain Rado Antolovic said at the formal signing of a joint venture agreement between Drydocks World and Cochin Shipyard for a ship repair facility in Kochi on Friday.

The agreement was signed in the presence of Sarbajit Sonowal, Union Minister of Ports, Shipping and Waterways, and Omran Sharaf Alhashimi, UAE Assistant Foreign Minister for Advanced Science and Technology.

“This partnership builds on the strong foundation of our MoU last year. By combining Cochin Shipyard’s local expertise and skilled workforce with Drydocks World’s global capabilities and technology, we are creat-

Dubai-based Drydocks World is keen on expanding ship repair, fabrication capability across India

ing a world-class ship repair offering. Our ambition goes beyond one facility — we see opportunities to expand ship repair and fabrication capabilities across India,” Antolovic said.

Speaking on the occasion, Sonowal said the joint venture is a significant step in strengthening India’s ship repair ecosystem and a major opportunity for Kerala to emerge as a leading maritime services hub. It will create additional capacity to service a wider range of vessels and meet the growing requirements of Indian, regional and international customers.

Move to hike power, weight ceiling on exempt EVs has industry divided

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

The government plans to raise the permissible motor power of low-speed electric scooters from 250 watts to 600 W and scrap the existing 60 kg weight ceiling for exemption from registration.

This has divided the industry between low-speed mobility players such as Yulu, which oppose the relaxation, and full-service electric two-wheeler original equipment manufacturers (OEMs) such as BGauss, which see a larger addressable market opening up.

MINISTRY’S PROPOSAL

Industry estimates put low-speed electric two-wheeler sales at 2.3-2.6 lakh units in FY26, up from 1.8-2.1 lakh in FY25. Volumes could reach 3.2-3.6 lakh units in FY27, implying potential growth of 30-35 per cent as regulatory



clarity and the entry of organised manufacturers broaden the category.

At the heart of the dispute is an August 21 draft notification from the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways. The proposed amendment to Rule 2(u) of the Central Motor Vehicles Rules raises the permitted 30-minute motor power from below 0.25 kW to below 0.6 kW while retaining maximum speed at below 25 kmph and removes the 60 kg unladen-weight ceiling.

INDUSTRY VIEW

However, the relaxation comes with tighter certification. Vehicles must have suit-

able brakes and retro-reflective devices and comply with safety requirements under law and be verified by an authorised testing agency.

Hemant Kabra, Founder and Managing Director of BGauss, said, “The low-speed segment getting organised is going to be one of the big factors and may result in much faster growth for organised companies.” BGauss has low-speed products “on the drawing board”.

Yulu’s objection goes to the other side of that equation. A company official said removing the 60 kg ceiling takes away the only physical constraint on how large and heavy a vehicle can become while continuing to qualify for the registration exemption. Motor power and maximum speed could potentially be altered electronically after sale, the official said, but weight cannot be changed through software.

‘Tamil Nadu can unlock ₹1.2 lakh cr in annual fiscal capacity’

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

Can Tamil Nadu improve its revenue position without resorting to higher borrowing or taxing citizens?

A report by global management consulting firm Kearney said that the State’s fiscal challenge could be addressed by better managing revenue already generated by its economy and ensuring spending discipline rather than introducing new taxes.

Narrowing Tamil Nadu’s efficiency gap with its peer States could create more than ₹1.2 lakh crore of annual fiscal capacity, without going for new taxes or additional borrowing, said the report, titled *Tamil Nadu’s fiscal crossroads*.

COMPLIANT FOLD

It lays down six solutions for the State to improve revenue

Seizing the opportunity		
Fiscal lever	Illustrative potential	
State own-tax revenue	~ ₹90,000 crore additional annual tax capacity	
State own non-tax revenue	~ ₹16,000 crore recurring	
Share in central taxes	~ ₹4,000 crore , dependent on divisible-pool growth	
Grants-in-aid	~ ₹17,000 crore through eligibility and readiness	
Revenue expenditure efficiency	~ ₹26,000 crore of fiscal space	
Capital expenditure	~ ₹17,000 crore in productive, quality-adjusted assets	

and spending, including GST collection efficiency, better excise revenue mop-up by use of differentiated rate structures, and guideline value rationalisation to increase stamp duty and registration revenue, among others.

The report points out that

Tamil Nadu’s monthly per capita expenditure is higher than that of peers such as Maharashtra, Karnataka and Gujarat, but its GST revenue as a per cent of the GSDP lags others.

Services contribute close to 53.6 per cent of Tamil Nadu’s GSDP but only 37.8

per cent of its GST collections, it added.

This is a combination of the impact of the unorganised services sector that is outside of the GST but also indicates “compliance shortfalls that are harder to justify,” the report said, recommending bringing more activity into the GST-compliant fold and to tighten enforcement against existing leakages.

LIQUOR REVENUE

On the excise front, “as a sin good, alcohol is well-suited to differentiated taxation by price tier... A distinct, higher excise rate for premium categories will allow Tamil Nadu to capture more revenue from consumers,” it said.

It also called for a need for end-to-end reconciliation of Tasmac’s procurement, sales and other elements through a track and trace mechanism.

Kashmir’s saffron farmers face challenges amid dry September

Gulzar Bhat
Srinagar

A strengthening El Nino is adding to concerns over warmer and drier conditions in Kashmir as the region’s saffron crop enters a crucial stage of its cultivation cycle.

September is a critical month for the saffron crop as corms begin to sprout after remaining dormant through the summer. Temperature and, particularly, soil moisture during this period can influence corm sprouting and the subsequent flower development.

“Rainfall is crucial during this month for the vegetative growth and development of the corms,” said Irshad Ahmad, a saffron farmer from Pampore, known for producing much of the Valley’s prized spice.



The saffron crop is largely rain-fed in Kashmir. Excessive heat and prolonged dryness during the sprouting stage can affect the crop’s development.

NATIONAL MISSION

Mukhtar Ahmad, Director of the India Meteorological Department, Srinagar, told *businessline* that daytime temperatures at several stations across Kashmir had

been recorded 2-4° C above normal, and that the warmer and dry conditions were likely to continue for a few more days.

“El Nino is there, but this is also the period when the South-West monsoon withdraws, and the resulting dry spell leads to a rise in daytime temperatures,” he said.

**TO ADVERTISE
PLEASE CONTACT**

Chennai : 044 - 28576300
Coimbatore : 0422 - 2212572
Madurai : 0452 - 2528497
Trichy : 0431 - 2302801
Puducherry : 0413 - 2224111

thehindu **businessline.**

QUICKLY.

Dr Reddy's launches Nivorz in India



Hyderabad: Dr Reddy's Laboratories has launched Nivorz in India, a significant milestone marking its entry into biosimilar immuno-oncology in India. Nivorz is a biosimilar to Opdivo (nivolumab). It is manufactured at Dr Reddy's biologics facility in Bachupally. **OUR BUREAU**

Samsung's India public policy chief resigns

New Delhi: Samsung India's head of public affairs and ESG Rajiv Aggarwal has resigned after nearly four years in the job, two sources with knowledge of the departure said on Tuesday. The reason for his resignation was not clear. Aggarwal is serving his last week at Samsung India, said the sources. **REUTERS**

Claude tool for financial advisors unveiled

AI lab Anthropic has launched a set of tools for financial advisors, connecting its Claude chatbot to investment analytics and wealth-management software from firms including BlackRock, Charles Schwab and Addepar. The product, called Claude for Financial Advisors, is designed to help financial service firms prepare for client meetings, review portfolios, investment research and handle follow-up work. It also builds on Anthropic's broader push into financial services. Anthropic's new offering connects Claude with data and software from firms including Envestnet, iCapital, Orion, Wealthbox, Wealth.com and Zocks. **REUTERS**

NPPA's limited powers a hurdle to 20% cap on medical device margins

RESTRICTED SCOPE. Pharma authority can directly fix prices only for scheduled devices

Ankita Upadhyay
New Delhi

The Parliamentary Standing Committee's call for a 20 per cent cap on the gap between the landing cost and MRP of medical devices faces a structural limitation because the National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority (NPPA) does not currently have blanket powers to impose a uniform margin cap across the entire medical device market.

Under the Drugs (Prices Control) Order, 2013 (DPCO), the NPPA can directly fix prices only for "scheduled" drugs and devices. For non-scheduled products, including the IV sets and catheters flagged by Maharashtra Food and Drug Administration (FDA) Commissioner Tukaram Mundhe, manufacturers determine the initial price.

The NPPA can only restrict subsequent annual increases to 10 per cent.



This means that implementing a blanket 20 per cent cap on non-scheduled devices would require extending the NPPA's existing mandate, either through a policy-level amendment to the DPCO or by bringing specific products under the Trade Margin Rationalisation (TMR).

CURRENT FRAMEWORK The NPPA, which functions under the Department of Pharmaceuticals, cannot unilaterally impose such a cap across the medical device market under the cur-

The issue gained urgency after a Maharashtra government survey found markups of up to 2,841% on commonly-used medical consumables

rent framework. It means that the NPPA does not have the authority to impose a uniform margin cap across all medical devices.

The issue gained urgency after a Maharashtra government survey found markups of up to 2,841 per cent on commonly-used medical consumables. Private hospitals were found to have procured IV infusion sets for around ₹11.05 apiece but billed patients ₹325, a markup of more than 2,800 per cent. Catheters, procured for about ₹29.41, were billed at ₹310.

The survey also covered syringes, nebulisers and oxygen masks.

UNIFORM CAP An industry person, on condition of anonymity, said the Committee's recommendation for a 20 per cent cap on the difference between the landing cost and MRP of medical devices, therefore, raises a fundamental question over the NPPA's existing powers. "A uniform cap would have to cover products that currently fall outside its direct price-fixing authority," he said.

The TMR could provide one route to address the gap, but it has so far been used only selectively, he added.

The Parliamentary Committee has criticised the delay in institutionalising the TMR.

The Committee's report also called for the government to expedite a permanent TMR framework under the DPCO, instead of relying on one-off interventions.

Meta agrees to share child safety matters directly with Indian cybercrime portal

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

Social media giant Meta on Tuesday said it will strengthen its efforts to combat child sexual abuse and report child safety matters directly to the cybercrime portal managed by the Indian Cybercrime Coordination Centre (I4C) from now. "Protecting children on our platforms is a priority for us and we're committed to working with the government to ensure that the per-

petrators of these crimes are held responsible," a Meta spokesperson said.

The development comes after stern warnings by the government to the company over the alleged circulation and promotion of child sexual abuse material (CSAM) through advertisements on Meta's Instagram. "To collectively strengthen our efforts to combat this harm, Meta will now report child safety matters directly to the cybercrime portal managed by I4C," the spokesperson added.



The government said that online safety of children was a "fundamental principle" for any social media platform operating in India and remains "non-negotiable," adding that the law of the land had to be followed by

any company operating in the country.

The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology said it was continuously in talks with all other platforms to identify and remove CSAM content, and action would be taken against any platform that doesn't take proactive steps for the safety of children.

The latest step by Meta is significant because social media platforms can be used to circulate or facilitate access to CSAM and other forms of exploitation.

Then & now: Update on last year's winners of Changemaker Awards

From changemaker to govt partner: Godaam Innovations secures Ministry contract to tackle onion spoilage

2025 WINNER.

YOUNG CHANGEMAKER

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

More success has come the way of Kalyani Shinde, Founder of Pune-based Godaam Innovations, who was the winner of the *businessline* Young Changemaker Award in 2025. "We have won a Union government contract, with the Ministry of Consumer Affairs giving us the responsibility to monitor onion in its warehouses," said Shinde over the telephone from Pune.

Shinde won the Young Changemaker Award for establishing India's first IoT-based onion storage solution device at Godaam Innovations. It monitors the microclimate of onion warehouses and tracks temperature, humidity and gases emitted during the early stages of spoilage. The device helps farmers detect waste early on, which can save most of their crop from sprouting and decaying.

Godaam is now testing the treatment of poultry products through an automatic system. "We hope to get this up and running soon," she said.

Godaam's intervention is crucial because farmers end up losing at least 25 per cent of the onions they store in the hope of getting good prices later in the season.

This is particularly crucial for the country, too, as it depends on the shelf-life of rabi onion, which is harvested in April and has to last at least until mid-September when the new early kharif crop arrives. Rabi onion makes up 70 per cent of India's total production.

Accepting the award last year, Shinde said, "When I began, the idea was not to launch a start-up but to help my family and community. I was witnessing the problem (onion rotting) first-hand as all my family is in agriculture," she said.

She said a massive amount of the kitchen staple rots every year in warehouses, and she was keen to reduce this post-harvest loss. "We have a saying in Nashik that onion can make or break governments," Shinde said, adding that consumers consume onion but farmers who grow it have to navigate a lot of problems to bring the produce to the plate.

REAL-TIME ALERTS

The technology developed by Shinde sends real-time alerts to farmers in their local language, empowering them to make timely decisions.



Kalyani Shinde, Founder, Godaam Innovations



Presents



Powered by



The system not only reduces wastage but also builds trust in storage infrastructure, making it possible to stabilise supply for the domestic and export markets.

She comes from Lasalgaon in Nashik, which houses Asia's largest onion market. She says that the innovation is helping onion farmers, and now Godaam Innovations is scaling beyond Maharashtra.

She said the company is building a warehouse management platform to connect buyers and sellers directly.

Shinde dreams of the day when farmers' children will be happy to be farmers.

THE POWER BEHIND PROGRESS

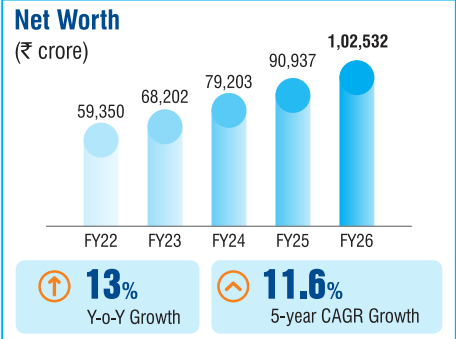
Excerpts of Chairman's Message at the 40th Annual General Meeting held on 31st August, 2026

Parminder Chopra, CMD

Dear Shareholders,

It gives me immense pleasure to welcome you to the 40th Annual General Meeting of Power Finance Corporation Limited.

As PFC completes four decades of nation building, we do so at a time when India itself is entering a new era of economic growth and infrastructure development.



The nation today stands at the cusp of a historic transformation—one where energy security, economic competitiveness and sustainable development are becoming increasingly interconnected.

India's aspiration of becoming a **Viksit Bharat by 2047** will not only be shaped by the pace of economic growth, but by our ability to build resilient infrastructure and ensure affordable, reliable and 24x7 power for every sector of the economy.

Building the Power Sector of Tomorrow

Over the past decade, India's electricity sector has demonstrated a remarkable progress. Installed generation capacity has more than doubled to over 520 GW, while peak electricity demand has crossed 250 GW, making India one of the world's fastest-growing electricity markets.

Unlike earlier decades, this growth is no longer driven solely by population expansion. It is being propelled by rapid industrialisation, increasing adoption of air conditioning, electric mobility, urbanisation, artificial intelligence, green hydrogen production and the emergence of large-scale data centres.

Four Decades of Nation Building

For forty years, Power Finance Corporation has fulfilled precisely this role.

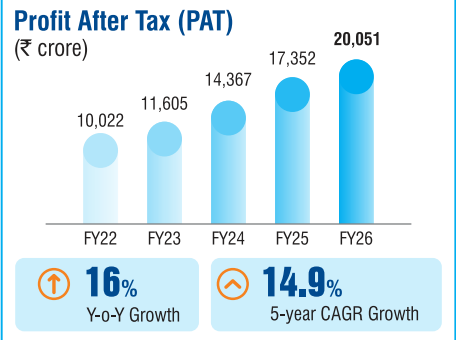
Established to strengthen India's power sector, PFC has evolved alongside the nation's changing priorities. From financing conventional power generation and transmission projects in its early years to supporting renewable energy, transmission corridors, energy storage, distribution reforms and emerging clean-energy technologies today, PFC has consistently adapted to the evolving needs of the sector while remaining true to its core purpose—to provide long-term financial support for projects that are critical to India's development.

As the nodal agency for the Revamped Distribution Sector Scheme (RDSS), PFC has played a critical role in strengthening the India's distribution sector by enabling investments in smart metering, infrastructure modernisation and operational efficiency. A strong and financially sustainable distribution sector remains the cornerstone of a resilient power system and will be critical to sustaining India's long-term energy security and economic growth.

With four decades of experience, PFC remains uniquely positioned to mobilise long-term capital, develop innovative financing solutions and partner with stakeholders in building India's future power ecosystem.

Delivering Performance with Purpose

Our performance during FY 2025–26 reflects not only strong financial outcomes but also our continued ability to anticipate the evolving needs of the sector and respond with discipline, agility and purpose.



During FY 26, PFC continued to be India's highest profit-making NBFC, while the PFC Group reaffirmed its leadership as India's largest NBFC Group with a consolidated balance sheet of around **₹12 lakh crore**.

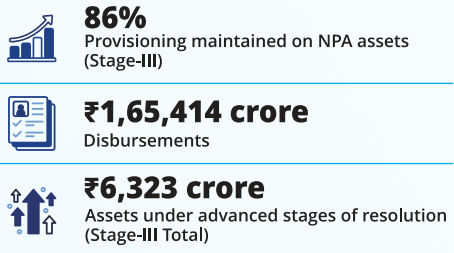
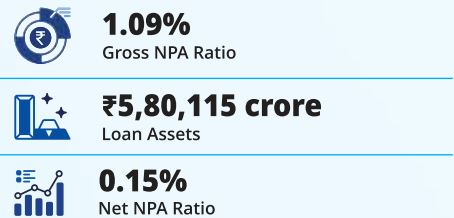


Smt. Parminder Chopra, CMD, PFC, along with Mr. Nick McCaffrey, Australia's Deputy High Commissioner to India and Shri K. Balasubramanian, MD, India CEO, Citi exchanging Loan Agreement. Export Finance Australia (EFA), the Australian Government's export credit agency is extending a guarantee to support PFC in raising USD 180 million from Citi.

On a consolidated basis, Profit After Tax increased to **₹33,625 crore**, while standalone Profit After Tax crossed **₹20,000 crore** for the first time, reaching **₹20,051 crore**. Standalone net worth surpassed the landmark **₹1 lakh crore**, significantly enhancing our capacity to finance India's growing infrastructure requirements.

Also, during FY 2025–26, we recorded annual disbursements of approximately **₹1.65 lakh crore**, while our loan assets expanded to **₹5.80 lakh crore**, with **₹90,135 crore**, of renewable book. Even as we grew, we maintained a healthy Capital Adequacy Ratio of **23.44%**, ensuring that our growth continues to be supported by a strong capital base.

The Board has recommended a dividend of **₹18.55 per share**, the highest in the Company's history, reflecting our



commitment to delivering sustainable value to our shareholders while preserving financial strength for future growth.

Recognising the increasing importance of sustainable finance, we have continued to strengthen our Environmental, Social and Governance (ESG) framework and integrate sustainability considerations into our financing strategy. Our objective is not merely to finance growth, but to finance growth responsibly, balancing commercial excellence with environmental stewardship and long-term societal impact.

During the year, we also expanded our engagement with leading international development finance institutions, including **Japan Bank for International Cooperation (JBIC)** and **Export Finance Australia (EFA)**, broadening access to diversified sources of long-term capital and reinforcing PFC's standing in global financial market.

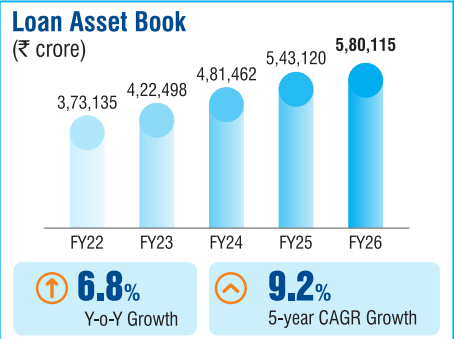
These achievements are not merely financial outcomes. They reflect disciplined lending, prudent capital allocation, robust governance and the continued confidence reposed in PFC by borrowers, investors, lenders and other stakeholders.

Building the Institution for India's Next Decade

FY 2025–26 also marked one of the most significant strategic developments in PFC's history.

The proposed merger of REC Limited with PFC represents much more than the coming together of two successful institutions. It is a strategic step towards strengthening India's development finance landscape.

Upon completion, the merged entity will create one of India's largest specialised infrastructure financing institutions, with an aggregate loan book of around **₹12 lakh crore**.



The combined scale will strengthen our ability to mobilise larger pools of domestic and international capital, diversify funding sources and finance increasingly complex infrastructure projects across the evolving value chain.



POWER FINANCE CORPORATION LTD.

(A Govt. of India Undertaking)
Regd. Office : "Urjanidhi", 1, Barakhamba Lane, Connaught Place, New Delhi-110 001, Ph.: 011-23456000, Fax : 011-23412545
www.pfcindia.co.in, CIN: L65910DL1986GOI024862

Connect with us on: @pfclndia

For borrowers, this will mean stronger and innovative financing capabilities. For investors, it offers enhanced operational efficiencies and long-term value creation. For the nation, it strengthens an institution capable of supporting one of the world's most ambitious energy transition and infrastructure investment programmes.

This is not simply an organisational milestone; it is an opportunity to build an institution that is better equipped to support India's next phase of economic growth.



Smt. Parminder Chopra, CMD (in centre) along with (Standing from L to R) Shri V. Packirisamy, Director (Commercial), Shri Rajesh Kumar Agarwal, Director (Finance), Shri Shashank Misra, Joint Secretary, Ministry of Power and Dr. Sudhir Mehta, Independent Director at the "Investors Meet 2026" held in Mumbai.

Looking Ahead

As we enter our **Fifth Decade**, we do so with a clear conviction: our role is no longer limited to financing power projects. Our responsibility is to help finance India's energy future.

Our priorities remain clear—to strengthen our leadership in power and infrastructure financing, accelerate sustainable and green finance, deepen access to global capital, preserve best-in-class asset quality and continue delivering consistent long-term value to all our stakeholders.

With a strong foundation and deep sectoral expertise, we are confident that PFC will continue to remain India's most trusted finance institution and a key partner in financing the India's journey towards Viksit Bharat 2047.

Acknowledgements

Before I conclude, I extend my sincere gratitude to the Government of India, the Ministry of Power, our regulators, auditors, lenders, investors, customers for their continued trust and partnership. I express my heartfelt gratitude to you, our shareholders, for your continued confidence in PFC.

Together, we will continue financing progress, powering possibilities and shaping the energy future of our nation.

Thank you.

(Parminder Chopra)
Chairman & Managing Director

(This does not purport to be a record of the proceedings of the Annual General Meeting held on 31st August, 2026. For full text, please visit : www.pfcindia.co.in)

#